Advanced Stab & Pillage: STABMASTER
Old School Edition (v7 rev5)

CHAPTER I: CHARACTERS

CREATING YOUR CHARACTER
The first thing to do is roll your attributes. Then choose a race (which might modify your attributes). Then choose a class (think of that as your career, or archetype). Your class will determine your starting skills and how many weapon proficiencies you get (and spells if you're into that). Now buy or upgrade skills with any remaining Building Points and your weapon proficiencies. Then determine your age (based on your class) in case it modifies any of your attributes. Then roll your hit points, roll your starting money (and optionally, your social standing and your flaws/traits). Then buy some equipment. Now that your character has been created, determine your MOVE scores, Armor Class and any combat bonuses. And try not to get killed.

1. Roll attributes
2. Choose a race
3. Choose a class
4. Buy or Upgrade Skills
5. Choose your weapon proficiencies
6. Determine your age
7. Modify/change attributes
8. Roll hit points
9. Roll starting money (and optionally, social standing and flaws/traits) and buy stuff
10. Determine your MOVE, Armor Class and Attack Bonuses (AB)

Starting With Higher Level Characters
There are times when a game needs to start characters off at a higher level. Just roll Hit Points for each level, add any new Building Points and proficiencies you would have gained, and there you have it. Appendix B gives a sample "quick start" from our DC 2008 dungeon crawl.

A Few Notes on Version 7:
Advanced Stab & Pillage is the greatest set of rules ever made. Once you accept that fact the rest of your reading will be a lot easier. But not much. Pretend you're 16. And there's no such thing as "storytelling" games. Now we're talking. Charts, stats, critical hits, and "Dungeon Masters" doing their best to get a TPK. You know the drill.

Seriously, though, Stabmaster is a tweaked version of the old home brew D&D rules that evolved over the many years of Campaign Theta. If anything, it's closer to the original AD&D than half the versions before it.

What's new in version 7? S&P, formerly "Hammers & Hatchets", was in sore need of a re-write. This homage to the good old days of hack n' slash cleans up some of the clutter and integrates the newer version of Telrhin that I use now. "Hammers & Hatchets" borrowed from and even referenced all sorts of out-of-print books (like the *Tome of Magic* and the *Wilderness Survival Guide*). I've jettisoned most of that schlock and stuck with the core stuff we loved from 1st edition AD&D. I got rid of 0 level character rules, re-organized the character classes, re-worked the skills (with help from Alex), added weapon speed, and got the magic rules back to basics.

Slice n' dice, baby!
Chris (March 2009)

Building Points
Characters begin with 2,000 Building Points (BP). These points can be spent to play as a non-human character and buy or improve skills. Once you've chosen a race and a class you will know how many points you have remaining and what

skills you will get for free. At that point you should look over the skills lists and see if there are any new skills you'd like to buy or skills you'd like to increase in level. If you have any remaining BP once you've created your character, keep the total marked on your character sheet: it may be too little to use now, but you will get more building points as you progress in your class level.

1.0 ATTRIBUTES

Characters all have seven attributes; Strength, Intelligence, Wisdom, Dexterity, Constitution, Charisma and Comeliness. Each score is determined by rolling four six sided dice, and discarding the lowest die.

Make any adjustments due to race at this point (prior to any "point trading").

You can trade 2 points from 1 attribute to add 1 point to another, up to 17. To raise an attribute to 18 you'll need to trade 3 points. You can only add 1 point to any attribute this way; for every additional point you add you get a roll on the bogey table.

> **Raising Attributes** (optional rule)
> This optional rule reflects the "heroic destiny" of player characters as they become more powerful and ignores logical limits on improvement in attributes like Comeliness. Another four six sided dice are rolled and the lowest discarded; this total may be distributed among the character's attributes to represent maximum ability scores (tallying an attribute to a maximum beyond 18 requires 2 points for every point up to 25). You may raise an ability score towards this maximum by spending 500xp times the new score (raising a score from 12 to 13 costs 6,500xp; raising it to 14 costs an additional 7,000xp).

1.1 STRENGTH

Strength (Str) is a measure of raw force, seen more as power than strength because it doesn't measure endurance. Strength checks are made to lift items, maintain a grip on something, and see how far you can push something or throw something (or someone!). A strength score of 15 is needed to wield a two-handed weapon without penalties (see 1.32 Two Handed Weapons).

> **To Hit** is the modifier on melee attack rolls
> **Dmg** is the damage modifier when attacking with a hand-held weapon or when throwing a weapon at very short range, and does not apply to most range weapons.
> **Max Press** is the "heaviest weight a character can pick up and lift over his head...in 1987, the world record for lifting a weight overhead in a single move was 465 pounds." (*Player's Handbook* 2nd ed)
> **Doors** is the number out of 20 to break open normal interior locked or held doors; the number in (parenthesis) is the number needed to break open a magically held door such as *Wizard Lock* or *Hold Portal*. The first roll may be attempted repeatedly on standard interior or light doors, the second just once per character.
> **Bars/Gates** is the percentage chance to bend simple bars or lift unfastened gates.

Score	To Hit	Dmg	Max Press	Doors	Bars/Gate	Notes
1	-5	-4	3	1	0%	
2	-3	-2	5	1	0%	
3	-3	-1	10	2	0%	
4-5	-2	-1	25	3	0%	
6-7	-1	0	55	4	0%	Avg Kobold
8-9	0	0	90	5	1%	Avg Haffer/Uruk
10-11	0	0	115	6	2%	Avg Human
12-13	0	0	140	7	4%	Avg Dw/Uruk-hai
14-15	0	0	180	8	7%	2H Weap. Min.
16	0	+1	220	10	12%	
17	+1	+2	260	11	19%	
18	+2	+3	310	13(3)	25%	
19	+3	+5	500	15(7)	40%	
20	+3	+7	660	17(10)	60%	
21	+4	+9	810	17(12)	70%	
22	+4	+10	970	18(14)	80%	
23	+5	+11	1,130	18(16)	90%	
24	+6	+12	1,440	19(17)	95%	
25	+7	+14	1,535	19(18)	99%	

1.2 INTELLIGENCE

Intelligence (Int) is one's raw wit and cleverness as well as a character's ability to reason and learn. Intelligence checks are made to problem solve, recall information, notice that someone is following or if there may be a trap ahead, as well as detect lies (deduction). Intelligence is also used to determine one's base MOVE score (reaction speed).

Score	Lang	ST	Notes
1-3	½	-5	Vegetal Intelligence
4	1	-4	Mentally Debilitated
5	1	-4	Extremely Slow of Mind
6-7	1	-3	Slow of Mind
8	1	-2	Not So Quick of Mind
9	2	-1	Average Humanoid Intelligence
10	3	0	Min for 5th Level Ritual
11	4	0	Quick of Mind
12	4	0	Min for 6th Level Ritual
13	4	0	Intelligent and Quick of Mind
14	5	0	Min for 7th Level Ritual
15	5	0	Highly Intelligent
16	6	0	Min for 8th Level Ritual
17	7	+1	Exceptionally Intelligent
18	8	+2	Min for 9th Level Ritual
19	10	+2	Immune 1st Level Illusions
20	12	+2	Immune 2nd Level Illusions
21	14	+2	Immune 3rd Level Illusions
22	*	+3	Immune 4th Level Illusions
23	*	+3	Immune 5th Level Illusions
24	*	+3	Immune 6th Level Illusions
25	*	+4	Immune 7th Level Illusions

Lang: Total number of languages the character can speak fluently.
ST : Modifier to Magic Saving Throw

High level creatures with high Intelligence scores have a chance to detect Invisibility:

Level	Intelligence Score 0-1	2-4	5-7	8-10	11-12	13-14	15-16	17+
07	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	5%
08	-	-	-	-	-	-	5%	10%
09	-	-	-	-	-	5%	10%	15%
10	-	-	-	-	5%	15%	20%	25%
11	-	-	-	5%	15%	25%	30%	35%
12	-	-	5%	15%	25%	35%	40%	45%
13	-	5%	10%	25%	35%	45%	50%	55%
14	5%	10%	15%	35%	45%	55%	65%	75%
15+	10%	15%	20%	45%	50%	65%	80%	95%

Detecting Invisibility means the forces at work only have partial effect. Usually this means the character can see a black & white blur of whatever person/object is invisible. Range is 40' (or range of Infravision, whichever is better).

Modifications by Invisibility Type:

TYPE 1: Blur fades between color and B&W, with more detail
TYPE 2: Vague B&W blur
TYPE 3: Glimpses of B&W blur, half range (20')
TYPE 4: Haze*, 1 tenth range (4')

*Haze: a hazing in the air, unrecognizable as anything other than a distortion (like gasoline fumes, extreme heat, etc.)

Spell Levels and Bonuses for Mages:

Score	Modification
10	Minimum for 5th level spells
12	Minimum for 6th level spells
14	Minimum for 7th level spells
16	Minimum for 8th level spells
17	1 additional point of Manna
18	Minimum for 9th level spells

(rumors of 10th level spells, known only by the archmage Beldigard, which would require an Intelligence of 20)

1.3 WISDOM

Wisdom (Wis) is a composite term for the character's enlightenment, judgment, willpower and, to a certain extent, intuitiveness. Wisdom checks are made in matters of will and self-control, detect lies (intuition) and to check for awareness of supernatural powers or creatures.

Score	ST	Holy Spells Usable & Notes
1-3	-5	Ignorant Bliss!
4-5	-4	
6-7	-3	
8	-2	First Level spells
9	-1	Second Level
10	0	Third Level
11	0	
12	0	Fourth Level
13	0	
14	0	5th Level
15	0	
16	0	
17	+1	6th Level
18	+1	7th Level
19	+2	
20	+2	
21	+2	
22	+3	
23	+3	
24	+4	
25	+5	

ST: Modifier to Natural/Holy Saving Throw

Spell Immunities (the spells listed are from the second edition *Player's Handbook*, the first edition *Players Handbook* if in **boldface**, though any version will do):

19 Cause Fear/ Charm Person/ Command/ Friends/ Hypnotism
20 Forget/ Hold Person/ Ray of Enfeeblement/ Scare
21 **Beguiling**/ Domination/ Fear
22 Charm Monster/ Confusion/ Emotion/ Fumble/ Suggestion/ **Telempathic Projection**
23 Chaos/ Feeblemind/ Hold Monster/ Magic Jar/ **Mass Domination**/ Quest
24 Geas/ Mass Suggestion/ Rod of Rulership
25 Antipathy & Sympathy/ Finger of Death or Death Spell/ Mass Charm/ Otto's Dance

Spell Point and Other Modifiers:

Score	Modification
9-10	Success Chance: 1-18
11	Success Chance: 1-19
15-16	1 additional spell point
17	2 additional spell points
18	3 additional spell points
19	4 additional spell points

What if your spellcasting character manages to have a lower Wisdom score than 9? It's possible, though the minimums for the main classes that can cast Clerical or Druidic spells are above 9. But if somehow this is you: the chance decreases by 2 for every point below 9, so Wisdom 8 would mean a SC of 1-16, and a Wisdom 7 would mean a Success Chance of 1-14 etc.

1.4 DEXTERITY

Dexterity (Dex) is a rating of quickness and agility. It ties in with base instincts and reflexes. Dexterity checks are made to maintain balance, avoid projectiles, move delicately, etc. Dexterity is also used to determine your base MOVE score.

THM is the bonus To Hit with Missile Weapons (range weapons). Rogues can use this in close combat and add it to their AB instead of their strength To Hit bonus (see Rogue Class).
AC is the modifier to Armor Class when your character has a chance to react.
TRAP is the modifier for Traps skill.

SCORE	THM	AC	TRAPS
01	-3	+4	-50%
02	-2	+4	-45%
03	-2	+4	-40%
04	-2	+3	-35%
05	-1	+2	-30%
06	0	+1	-25%
07	0	0	-20%
08	0	0	-15%
09	0	0	-10%
10	0	0	-10%
11	0	0	-5%
12	0	0	0%
13	0	0	0%
14	0	0	0%
15	0	-1	0%
16	+1	-2	0%
17	+1	-3	0%
18	+2	-4	+5%
19	+3	-4	+10%
20	+3	-4	+15%
21	+4	-5	+20%
22	+4	-5	+25%
23	+4	-5	+30%
24	+5	-6	+35%
25	+5	-6	+40%

1.5 CONSTITUTION

Constitution (Con) is a measure of physical health and endurance. Con checks are made when running distances, exposure to disease, performing a strenuous task, and going without sleep.

HP ADJ is the adjustment made to each level rolled for Hit Points; only dwarves, humans and orcs can gain more than +2.
NO'S are the numbers that may be re-rolled on the die for Hit Points; 2 means 2 and below, etc.
ST ADJ is the adjustment to Saving Throws vs Poison. This would be higher except Constitution is the base for Saving Throws to start with.
REGEN is the number of rounds before a character regenerates 1 Hit Point.
HEAL d is the die rolled for HP recovery as outlined under Chapter II: Combat.

SCORE	01	02	03	04	05	06	07	08	09	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25
HP ADJ	-3	-3	-2	-1	-1	-1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	+1	+2	+2	+3	+4	+5	+5	+6	+6	+7	+7
NO'S	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	1	1	2	2	3	3	3
ST ADJ	-2	-1	-1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	+1	+1	+2	+2	+3	+3	+4
REGEN	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	6	5	4	3	2	1
HEAL d	1	1	1	2	3	3	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	6	6	6	8	8	8	10	10	10	10

1.6 CHARISMA & COMELINESS

Charisma (Ch) is personability, affability, charm, panache, etc. It's subjective and varies somewhat by culture. An orc with high charisma might be hated by dwarves, but worshipped by other orcs, a warrior's "stoic leadership" might be ridiculed among thieves, etc. Charisma checks are made to see how receptive someone might be to suggestion, how loyal a follower might be in a dangerous spot, how good a price you get at the market, and how much information a stranger may be willing to give you.

Comeliness (Cm) is the measure of a character's physical beauty (or lack thereof). It's a subjective number relative to each cultural/sub-culture's take on beauty. Comeliness is modified as follows:

Ability Score	Cm Adj
Charisma:	
2 or less	-8
3	-5
4-5	-3
6-8	-1
13-15	+1
16-17	+2
18	+3
19 or more	+4
Int 7 or below	-1
Str 17 or more	+1
Str 7 or below	-1
Constitution:	
24 or above	+5
21-22	+4
20	+3
19	+2
18	+1
7	-1
6-5	-2
4-3	-3
2 or below	-4

COMELINESS TABLE

score	general info	RM
-5	ghastly	-10
-4	putrid	-9
-3	grotesque	-8
-2	horrid	-7
-1	nauseating	-6
0	revolting	-5
1	shocking	-4
2	hideous	-3
3	repulsive	-2
4	offensive	-1
5	ugly	0
6	unattractive	0
7	plain	0
8-11	average	0
12	modest	0
13	dapper	0
14	pretty	0
15	dignified	+1
16	handsome	+2
17	refined	+3
18	striking	+3
19	beautiful	+3
20	gorgeous	+4
21	illustrious	+4
22	magnificent	+5
23	exquisite	+5
24	exalted	+5
25	rapturous	+7

RM = “Reaction Modifier” for Charisma checks

2.0 HERO POINTS & ALIGNMENT

2.1 HERO POINTS

Hero Points are a player tool (PCs only) to help influence the story by allowing re-rolls and the “shaking off” of injuries. Characters get 1 Hero Point per level. They are just a mechanic of the rules and don’t exist in the game world, though some magical relics and artifacts might provide additional Hero Points in addition to their other powers. A character can only have 1 Hero Point at a time: any Hero Points over 1 are converted to Hit Points and added to the character’s HP total as a reward for not having used it.

You can spend a Hero Point to:

- Get another roll: you can spend a point to re-roll the dice. It just applies to your rolls and can’t be used to re-roll for other characters or DM controlled events.

- Ignore a damage roll: you can spend a point to ignore 1 damage roll (before or after it's rolled). This applies to one roll, not combined rolls, so if you get stabbed by 50 kobolds you can only ignore 1 of their rolls. Also, you can only ignore up to 50 points of damage (you can't jump off a cliff or walk through lava just by spending a Hero Point).

Spent Hero Points do not come back.

Legacy Characters: If we run any characters from the old days we'll ignore Hero Points since it would be a wild guess if they had any and how many hit points might have been added.

What About Regular People and Monsters?
This is where the rules and the world diverge. Classes are designed for adventurers, Player Character adventurers to be precise, and regular folks like farmers and barmaids aren't usually defined the same way. There are 3 general categories for non-adventurers:

Extras: These are common people with no great skills who may be good at what they do but it's not adventuring. They get relevant stats for attributes and skills but are generally referred to as "zero level" extras.

Creatures: Monsters and other good things to poke a stick at are usually statted up using Hit Dice instead of a character class (each die is roughly equal to a level and they fight on the Warrior column). They may have skills as well.

Major Villains and Heroes: these guys are usually treated like Player Characters.

2.2 ALIGNMENT
Alignment is a character's ethos. In a fantasy world, forces of 'good' and 'evil' are palpable realities influenced by gods, magic and natural powers. Characters choose an alignment and follow it for their entire lives (usually). However, since alignment is a large part of a character's identity and persona, a player can opt to change their alignment after their first session if it doesn't seem to be working with how their character is developing.

Characters who betray their alignment get docked experience, and constant behavior outside of a character's alignment can lead to a forced alignment change, usually coupled with an experience penalty.

Alignments follow the old D&D axis of good-neutral-evil and lawful-neutral-chaotic: a character is Lawful Good, Neutral Evil, Chaotic Good, etc. Generally, Lawful Good and Chaotic Evil characters are a royal pain in the ass to run, and to a lesser extent so are Neutral Neutral characters. Chaotic Neutral is the old "I do whatever the hell I want" alignment, which though liberating also means having no loyalty to your fellow adventurers and can be perceived as Evil by those forces who are working against Evil.

3.0 CHARACTER CLASSES

Classes are adventuring archetypes. They represent the basic adventuring "careers" and guide the story of the character. Classes fall into three general categories, Warriors, Rogues and Adepts. These categories help establish some basic rules for the classes contained in them, and often a rule will refer to an entire category instead of just a class (i.e. "Warriors roll on a d10").

CHARACTER CLASS	REQUIREMENTS
WARRIORS	
Fighters	Str 9, Con 7
Paladins/Knights	Str 12, Int 9, Wis 13, Con 9, (Paladins: Cha 17), Alignment (by Order)
Rangers	Str 13, Int 13, Wis 14, Con 14, Alignment (Good)

ROGUES	
Thieves	Dex 9
Assassins	Str 12, Int 11, Dex 12 Alignment (Neutral or Evil)
Bards	Wis 15, Dex 15, Cha 15, Int 12

ADEPTS	
Mages	Int 9, Dex 6 (Illusionists Int 15, Dex 16)
Clerics	Wis 9
Druids	Wis 12, Cha 15, Alignment (Neutral-Neutral)

Most Skills are available to characters outside their class to let you create a Fighter who has thieving skills or a Mage who fights, or some other combination.

Monks, Cavaliers, Duelists, Mystics and Barbarians: over the years there were a ton of specialty classes from Unearthed Arcana and Dragon Magazine (and of course our own endless home brew creations). In the spirit of AD&D 1st Edition, they still exist but just aren't covered in these rules.

Multiclass Characters (optional rule)
Multiclass is a dual-class combination where the character chooses 2 classes and splits their experience between them. Multiclass characters fight on the preferred class column. Starting Hit Points are rolled for both classes then divided by 2 (don't round – you keep the fraction for later use). Constitution bonus is added after dividing. Starting Proficiencies and Building Points are also averaged, rounding up.

Experience is split between the two classes based on class usage: most experience is split 50-50, but an adventure where a fighter/magic-user never casts a spell might be 90-10. When you reach a new level Hit Points are rolled and divided by 2 (keep the fraction) and half of the Constitution bonus is added (keep the fraction).

Class Combat Limitations: multiclass characters fight on the preferred fighting column, but limitations on weapons still apply (requiring a second proficiency). Armor rules for magery apply as do skill penalties for thieves.

Adding Multiclass Later On: You can add a second class any time. Other than creating the back-story as to why and how the character suddenly starts casting spells and studying magery (for instance), it's just a matter of adding the new class with an experience point total of zero. No Hit Points are rolled until the new class exceeds the old class level at the time: if a 4th level fighter becomes a fighter/thief they won't roll HP for their thief class until they reach 5th level. Other than skills that come with the class you don't get the Building Points or Proficiencies for the first level and though you gain Building Points for new levels you don't gain new proficiencies until you've surpassed your other class level. If the character is using a weapon type that requires an additional proficiency in the new class, it can still be used but once a new Proficiency slot is available it has to be spent on that weapon.

Experience Point Bonus (optional rule):
Instead of gaining a bonus 10% to experience based on the primary attribute of each character class, the 10% bonus comes from having a high Wisdom (16 or better). For Clerics, since Wisdom *is* their primary attribute, the bonus is based on both Intelligence (+5% for Intelligence 15 or better) and Wisdom (+5% for 16 and better).

3.1 WARRIORS

Warriors do most of the hacking and are an indispensible part of any adventuring party. They are the best melee fighters of the classes and usually end up at the front of any good fight. Mages, however, refer to them as 'meat shields'.

Warriors fight on the Warrior Column when attacking and roll a d10 for Hit Points.

3.11 Fighters

Fighters are, well, the fighters of the fantasy world. They don't have spells or magic, and they aren't necessarily good with animals and nature like a ranger, but they are very good at killing things.

Characters need a minimum of 9 Strength and 7 Constitution to be a fighter. Fighters with Str and/or Con of 17 or better gain an additional 10% to experience earned.

They start with 4 proficiencies along with Healing and Riding (War Horse at level 1 or Riding Horse at level 3), and Brawling 2. They also receive Smith when they reach 3rd level.

Fighters get d10 hit points per level.

EXPERIENCE TABLE

up to 2,000	lvl 1
up to 4,000	lvl 2
up to 8,000	lvl 3
up to 18,000	lvl 4
up to 35,000	lvl 5
up to 70,000	lvl 6
up to 125,000	lvl 7
up to 250,000	lvl 8
up to 500,000	lvl 9
up to 750,000	lvl 10
up to 1,000,000	lvl 11
up to 1,250,000	lvl 12

250,000 experience points for every level beyond the 12th

In AD&D each class levels had a 'title' and starting at 9th level fighters were called 'Lord'. It was pretty cheesy: "hello, I am a Scutifer". Ironically, fighters at 1st level were "veterans".

Fighters have no restrictions on armor or weapons and are also able to use most skills and magical items.

Swings per attack at higher levels:

0-6	1/1
7-12	3/2
13+	2/1

Ability progression for levels 2-9:

3. GAIN/ADD Smith
4. One proficiency
7. 3/2 attacks, one proficiency
10. One proficiency
13. 2/1 attacks

"A knight of Gorgmir serves his liege till death; his honor he wears proudly, and the gods he reveres above all."

Duke Lassoin of Taurania

3.12 Paladins and Knights

Paladins and Knights are specialized fighters. They both serve martial orders and a liege; orders with Paladins are of a fundamentalist religious nature whereas Knights may or may not have a religious element to their order. Both Paladins and Knights follow a strict code based on their martial order and suffer penalties to their experience for infractions (as well as world–related punishment where applicable). If the penalty ever exceeds the total for the sessions, they lose their specialty class and follow the Fighter class from then on (in some cases ultra-repentant characters could regain their class).

Paladins get d10 Hit Points per level, Knights get 2d6 Hit Points per level.

EXPERIENCE TABLE

up to 2,750	lvl 1
up to 5,500	lvl 2
up to 12,000	lvl 3
up to 24,000	lvl 4
up to 45,000	lvl 5
up to 95,000	lvl 6
up to 175,000	lvl 7
up to 350,000	lvl 8
up to 700,000	lvl 9
up to 1,050,000	lvl 10
up to 1,400,000	lvl 11
up to 1,750,000	lvl 12
up to 2,100,000	lvl 13

350,000 experience points for every level beyond the 13th.

3.121 Paladins

Paladins are religious warriors at either end of the spectrum (Lawful Good or Lawful Evil). They gain limited spells at higher levels and have to follow the doctrine of their order and god(s). They also have innate holy powers. Unlike Clerics they are not necessarily priests and function more as religious knights.

Paladin Abilities

- Detect Evil 60'
- All Saving Throws +2
- Immunity from all forms of disease
- Cure wounds (once per day for 2hp per level)
- Cure disease (once per week)
- Certain "holy weapons" allow paladins to project a 10ft diameter Level dispelling magic as mage of same level
- 3rd level: Turn Undead as Cleric (2 levels lower)

- 9th level: Use of Cleric spells.

Paladin Restrictions

- May never retain more than 10 magic items
- May never retain wealth beyond what is needed to maintain equipment, travel and modest living
- 10% of their loot goes to their church ASAP

Manna Points (starting at 9th Level): 1 point per level after 8th plus Wisdom bonus (if any)

[Manna = 1 per level after 8th + Wisdom bonus]

Ability progression for levels 2-10

3. Turn Undead
4. One proficiency
7. One proficiency
9. Cleric Spells
10. One proficiency

Paladins begin with 4 weapon proficiencies along with Riding (War Horse 1 or Riding 3), Heraldry, Etiquette, and Healing

Paladins can also Turn Undead (see Clerics for more details).

3.122 Knight

Knights are feudal warriors who serve a martial order. They do not gain spells or magical powers, however they do have certain specialized skills.

Knights choose a primary weapon to specialize in (often restricted by their order) and roll the next highest damage die whenever using it (d8 becomes d10, etc but d12 becomes 2d6+1).

Knights follow a strict code, sometimes putting them at odds with the party's needs. Some knights must always attack bandits or help women in distress. Others can't retreat in battle or turn down a challenge. Some must always attack certain races, likes Orcs or Kobolds, or Elves. A few sample codes are included below.

Knights are tied to the politics, agenda and whims of their order; they usually have a set of side tasks or missives, some of them secret. Sometimes this means a knight can't travel to certain realms, or absolutely has to stop and deliver a message to an allied order or court that's *kind of* on the way. Knightly orders often involve errands for the liege (or lady) or standing orders, like bringing them any treasure that bears the crest of a certain king, or silk of a certain color, or a cask of booze that happens to be extra tasty.

They also re-roll 1s at all level when rolling for Hit Points.

Knights are heavily trained in the use of the lance for jousting - this allows them to add their level to the damage rolled when using a lance from horseback.

Swings per attack at higher levels:

0-7	1/1
8-13	3/2
14+	2/1

Ability progression for levels 2-10

4. One proficiency
7. One proficiency
8. 3/2 attacks
10. One proficiency
14. 2/1 attacks

Knights begin with 4 proficiencies, War Horse Riding 2, Heraldry, Etiquette, and Healing

"In the name of the Dragon, the Kingdom, and the Sword, I give you the right to bear arms and the power to meet justice beneath the Sun."

Excerpt from the Knighting Ceremony of Dalmatos

Sample Bane Knight Code (The Knights of Krag Durn - The Order of the Free Sword)

The Code
Devotion unto death to thy God
Fealty unto death to thy God's servant on earth, thy Liege
Service to those who hold rank above thee
Service to the Oligarchy of Krag Durn
Service to the Tradesmen of Krag Durn
Service to the Peasants of Krag Durn

General Code
Battle is Glory
Death to all who oppose the Cause
Death before dishonor
Sickness and frailty is dishonor

Sample Knight Code (The Knights of Gorgmir)

The Code
Noble service cheerfully rendered
Defense of any charge unto death
Courage and enterprise in obediences to rule
Respect for all peers and equals
Honor to all above your station
Obedience and respect from all beneath your station
Scorn for all those who are lowly and ignoble
Military prowess exercised in service to your lord
Courtesy to all Ladies

General Code

War is the flowering of chivalry
Battle is the test of manhood
Combat is Glory
Personal Glory above all in battle
Death before dishonor

Knights are expected to uphold the honor of their own name, their liege, their order and everything that goes with it. This includes the shield device and colors or their order.

3.13 Rangers
(Rangers follow the 1st Ed experience progression, roll d10 for Hit Points (like warriors). At higher levels they can cast Druid spells)

Rangers start with 4 weapon proficiencies, Riding (Riding Horse) at 3rd level, Tracking, Archery, Healing, Herbal Lore and Wildlife. Rangers can add their class level to their Riding skills.

Rangers need a minimum Strength and Intelligence of 13, and a Wisdom and Constitution of 14. They also have to be good aligned, but a good back story could change this. Although they can wear full armor if the situation requires it, no self-respecting ranger will wear metal armor on a regular basis.

3.2 ROGUES

Rogues are the stealthy and nimble set, good at picking pockets, sneaking past guards and disarming traps. Every party needs one (but probably not 2)

Rogues subtract their level from Falling Damage.

Thieves start with 3 proficiencies along with Pick Pockets, Haggling 2, Locks, Stealth, Shadows, Hear Noise, Climbing, Traps, Decipher Runes, and Streetwise 2.

Assassins start with 4 proficiencies along with Stealth, Shadows, Hear Noise, Streetwise, Traps, Disguise, and Climbing.

Bards begin with 3 proficiencies, Music 2, Decipher Runes, Acting, Etiquette, and History Lore.

At 9th lvl Thieves and Assassins are trained in Alchemy and the ability to read magically veiled scrolls (they would still need to decipher the text if it's in an unknown tongue).

Thieves and Assassins have a special Backstab bonus of +4 (vs. +2) and instead of adding their level to damage they can choose to double the damage. All other backstab rules apply.

Rogues fight on the Rogues Column when attacking. Rogues roll a d6 for Hit Points.

Rogues usually don't wear armor heavier than leather because of the skill penalties.

"A thief is an artist: night's the palette, fingers his brush, and luck his patron."
High Priest Man Krystos of Bel

3.21 Thieves

Thieves are burglars and crooks who rob and occasionally resort to mugging and brigand work. They are most often stealthy cat-burglars and quick shoplifters, con men and gamblers, tomb-robbers and adventurers.

Thieves require a minimum Dexterity of 9. With a Dexterity of 17 or better they earn an additional 10% to experience gained.

They may use any single-handed weapon four feet or shorter, but other weapon types cost them an additional proficiency. Thieves are masters of thrown weapons (knives, shurikans).

Thieves get d6 Hit Points per level.

EXPERIENCE TABLE

up to 1,250	lvl 1
up to 2,500	lvl 2
up to 5,000	lvl 3
up to 10,000	lvl 4
up to 20,000	lvl 5
up to 42,500	lvl 6
up to 70,000	lvl 7
up to 110,000	lvl 8
up to 160,000	lvl 9
up to 220,000	lvl 10
up to 440,000	lvl 11
up to 660,000	lvl 12
up to 880,000	lvl 13
up to 1,100,000	lvl 14

220,000 experience points for every level beyond the 14th.

Thrown weapons per attack at higher levels

0-7	2/1
8-12	3/1
13+	4/1

Thief ability progression chart for levels 2-10:

5. Triple backstab damage, one proficiency
8. 3/1 thrown weapons
9. Quadruple backstab damage, Alchemy, one proficiency
13. 4/1 thrown weapons

3.22 Assassins

Assassins are killers, spies and sometimes just plain thugs. They have an even better bonus when backstabbing and begin with more proficiencies. They also have a progression table for swings per round.

Assassins require a minimum Strength 12, Intelligence 11, and Dexterity 12. They also must be Neutral or Evil.

Assassins get d6 Hit Points per level.

EXPERIENCE TABLE

up to 1,500	lvl 1
up to 3,000	lvl 2
up to 6,000	lvl 3
up to 12,000	lvl 4
up to 25,000	lvl 5
up to 50,000	lvl 6
up to 100,000	lvl 7
up to 200,000	lvl 8
up to 300,000	lvl 9
up to 425,000	lvl 10
up to 575,000	lvl 11
up to 750,000	lvl 12
up to 1,000,000	lvl 13
up to 1,500,000	lvl 14

500,000 experience points for every level beyond the 14th.

In the old games Assassins maxed out at 15th level at "Grandfather of Assassins".

Swings per attack at higher levels:

0-8	1/1
9-14	3/2
15+	2/1

Assassin ability progression chart for levels 2-10:

5. Triple backstab damage, one proficiency
8. One proficiency
9. 3/2 swings per attack; Quadruple backstab damage, Alchemy

3.23 Bards

Bards are minstrels; travelers who perform for money and steal a few sets of silverware when in the kitchen. They aren't the best thieves or assassins, but they do have some minor magical talents and are surprisingly good in a fight.

Bards require a minimum Wisdom, Dexterity and Charisma of 15, and an Intelligence of 12.

To account for that certain charmed existence led by bards, they may add their Manna Points to any roll of theirs. This can be done before or after the dice are rolled, but only applies to rolls the player makes, not the Dungeon Master.

Bards get d6 Hit Points per level.

EXPERIENCE TABLE

up to 1,500	lvl 1
up to 3,000	lvl 2
up to 6,000	lvl 3
up to 12,000	lvl 4
up to 25,000	lvl 5
up to 50,000	lvl 6
up to 100,000	lvl 7
up to 200,000	lvl 8
up to 300,000	lvl 9
up to 425,000	lvl 10
up to 575,000	lvl 11
up to 750,000	lvl 12
up to 1,000,000	lvl 13
up to 1,500,000	lvl 14

500,000 experience points for every level beyond the 14th.

Bard ability progression chart for levels 2-10:

5. One proficiency
7. First level Druid spells
8. One proficiency
9. 2nd Level Druid Spells
12. 3rd Level Druid spells
14. One proficiency
15. 4th Level Druid spells

Starting at 7th level, Bards can cast Druid spells. They get one point of manna per level after 6th plus their Wisdom bonus:

[Manna = 1 per level after 6th plus Wisdom bonus]

spell level	1	2	3	4
class level	7	9	12	15

Bard Abilities:

- Raise morale while playing/singing: A radius of 10ft + 1ft/level, adds +1 to Saving Throws and follower/hireling morale checks, and Armor Class by 1. The bard can't attack while doing this, but they can defend; the playing/singing takes 1 minute to start taking effect.

- Impress the Folks: Bards get a +1 per 3 level bonus on Charisma checks if the target has recently seen them

perform. Without performing they get a +1.

- Free Room and Board: in ordinary circumstances a bard doesn't pay for lodging or food (and sometimes the bar tab) if they perform.

- At 7th level: Bards can cast Druid spells.

3.3 ADEPTS

3.31 Mages

Mages are either Magic-Users or Illusionists, the only practical difference being the type of spells they use. Mages require an Intelligence of 9 and Dexterity of 6 (Specialist Magic-Users have additional requirements listed below). Illusionists need a minimum Intelligence of 15 and Dexterity of 16.

Non-specialized Magic-Users with an Intelligence of 17 or better earn an additional 10% to experience gained.

Magic-Users Specialist Requirements

SPECIALIST	SCHOOL	REQ	OPPOSITION SCHOOL
Abjurer	Abjuration	Wis 15	Alteration & Illusion
Conjurer	Conj/Summ	Con 15	Gr Divination & Invoc/Evoc
Diviner	Gr Divin	Wis 16	Conj/Summ
Enchanter	Ench/Charm	Cha 16	Invoc/Evoc & Necromancy
Illusionist	Illusion	Dex 16	Necro, Invoc/Evoc, Abjur
Invoker	Invoc/Evoc	Con 16	Ench/Charm & Conj/Summ
Necromancer	Necromancy	Wis 16	Illusion & Ench/Charm
Transmuter	Alteration	Dex 15	Abjuration & Necromancy

Mages receive two points per level worth of Manna Points (plus Intelligence bonus, if any):

[Manna = 2 Points Per Level]

Note that specialist mages receive one extra point of Manna per level. The stipulation is that specialists must use these points on spells from their school of magic.

Mages start with 2 proficiencies, along with History Lore 2, Herb Lore 2, Decipher Runes 2.

Starting Spells: Mages begin with a grimoire of spells. Players can go through the first level spell list from 1st Edition and make a Spellcasting roll for each spell (half Intelligence plus class level) for each spell to see if they might know it, then from that list choose up to 3d4 spells.

Mages roll a d4 for Hit Points each level.

EXPERIENCE TABLE

up to 2,500	lvl 1
up to 5,000	lvl 2
up to 10,000	lvl 3
up to 22,500	lvl 4
up to 40,000	lvl 5
up to 60,000	lvl 6
up to 90,000	lvl 7
up to 135,000	lvl 8
up to 250,000	lvl 9
up to 375,000	lvl 10
up to 750,000	lvl 11
up to 1,125,000	lvl 12
up to 1,500,000	lvl 13
up to 1,875,000	lvl 14
up to 2,250,000	lvl 15
up to 2,625,000	lvl 16
up to 3,000,000	lvl 17
up to 3,375,000	lvl 18

375,000 experience points for every level beyond the 18th.

Mages require an Intelligence of 12 and Dexterity of 9 (Specialist Mages have additional requirements listed below). Those with Iq of 17 or better earn an additional 10% to experience gained.

Mages can wear armor, but it interferes with casting; they can't cast in metallic armor of any kind, and non-metal armor doubles the manna point cost of a spell.

Mages can use daggers, slings, and staves; they can use any other weapon at the cost of an additional proficiency.

Mages can create new spells at 9th lvl, recharge staves at 10th lvl, write scrolls at 11th lvl, and enchant a staff, talisman or robe for casting at 13th. In addition, Mages are trained for the PENTAGRAM Skill at 3rd, THAUMATURGIC TRIANGLE Skill at 6th, and in ALCHEMY at 7th, if they have not already acquired these skills.

Mages may cast spells from all Nine Levels of Ritual magic depending on their level.

Spell Level	1	2	3		4	5		6	7		8	9
Class Level	0-2	3 4	5	6	7 8	9 10	11	12 13	14	15	16 17	18

Ability progression for levels 2-18:

3. Second Level spells, GAIN Pentagram power
5. Third Level spells, one proficiency
6. GAIN Thaumaturgic Triangle power
7. Fourth Level spells, GAIN Alchemy

9. Fifth Level spells, GAIN Create Spells power, one proficiency,
10. GAIN Recharge Stave power
11. GAIN Write Scrolls power
12. Sixth Level spells
13. Enchant Cowling, one proficiency
14. Seventh Level spells
16. Eight Level spells
17. One proficiency
18. Ninth Level spells

3.32 Clerics

Clerics are the priest-warriors of the world, no slouch in a fight and able to cast holy spells like healing.

Clerics require a minimum Wisdom of 9. Clerics with a Wisdom greater than 15 gain an additional 10% to experience earned.

Clerics roll a d8 for Hit Points each level.

EXPERIENCE TABLE

up to 1,500	lvl 1
up to 3,000	lvl 2
up to 6,000	lvl 3
up to 13,000	lvl 4
up to 27,000	lvl 5
up to 55,000	lvl 6
up to 110,000	lvl 7
up to 225,000	lvl 8
up to 450,000	lvl 9
up to 675,000	lvl 10
up to 900,000	lvl 11

225,000 experience points for every level beyond the 11th.

Clerics can wear any form of armor (except for a few rare restrictions from certain religions); they can also use most weapons, but these are often restricted to blunt weapons like maces in many religions.

A Few of the Main Lowland Religions ("sparse, widespread" etc indicate how commonly each religion is practiced in the Lowlands):

- **Tala Goddess of Wisdom / Luna Goddess of Wile** (Lowland Moon Faith) (widespread): anyone-handed weapon for Luna, blunt weapons for Tala: NG and CG, with some NN, CN or NE (esp for Luna)
- **Valek God of Sea and Storms / Varas Goddess of the Spirit World (**Valek Storm Gods) (widespread): none: CN, CE, CN, NN and some CG
- **Mahal (the Maker) and the Dwarven Gods** (widespread): hammers or other blunt weapons: NG, NN, LG and some LG
- **Bel God of Luck** (Merchant and Thief God) (widespread): blunt weapons: NN, NG, CG, NE
- **Seht God of Night & Sorcery** (God of Dark Sorcery) (sparse): knives and daggers and staves: CE, CN, NE
- **Falasrion** (Elven God) (sparse): none: NG, LG

- **Ninrandivel** (Southron Dragon God) (sparse): blunt weapons: NG, LG
- **Thar-Emykl** (Evil God of Vengeance and Anger) (sparse): none: LE, NE
- **Sylas** (North Star, Goddess of Sailors, certain Druidic Cults and Adventurers) (widespread): blunt weapons: NG, LG, some LN
- **Gruumsh** (main Orc God) (sparse): none: CE, NE
- **The Elephant God** (animist Akani faith) (widespread in Akania): NG, CG, NN and CN.
- **Septar, God of Justice / Seneca, Goddess of Purity & Healing** (the main gods of the Rayikian Faith) (sparse): LG, NG, blunt weapons, women only for Senecan priests and clerics
- **Ryrg Velkrin** (Evil God of Suffering and Lust) (rare and in secret): one-handed except staves, CE, NE

Clerics receive one point of Manna per level plus their Wisdom bonus (if any):

[Manna = 1 Point Per Level + Wisdom Bonus]

They start with 3 proficiencies, along with Herb Lore 2, Decipher Runes 2, History Lore, and Astrology. At 4th they are trained to the HOLY CIRCLE Skill, and at 6th trained for Alchemy, if they do not already have these skills.

They also have the ability to Turn Undead.

TURNING
This is the divine ability to turn spirits and undead. The holy symbol must be held aloft and visible; the range of turning is 10 yards per level. Evil characters can choose to command the undead into service at half the target number (they can try one or the other, not both).

A successful roll allows a further roll next segment. If a roll fails, then no rolls may be made for that creature type again for that encounter.

Paladins turn at 2 levels lower, Druids at half their level.

	Class Lv									
Undead	01	02	03	04	05	06	07	08	9-13	14+
Skeleton	10	7	4	T	T	D	D	X	X	X
Zombie	13	10	7	T	T	D	D	D	X	X
Ghoul	16	13	10	4	T	T	D	D	D	X
Shadow	19	16	13	7	4	T	T	D	D	X
Wight	20	19	16	10	7	4	T	T	D	D
Ghast	-	20	19	13	10	7	4	T	T	D
Wraith	-	-	20	16	13	10	7	4	T	D
Mummy	-	-	-	20	16	13	10	7	4	T
Specter	-	-	-	-	20	16	13	10	7	T
Vampire	-	-	-	-	-	20	16	13	10	4
Ghost	-	-	-	-	-	-	20	16	13	7
Lich	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	19	16	10
Special	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	20	19	13

T 1-12 undead are automatically turned.

D 1-12 undead are automatically destroyed.
X 7-12 undead are automatically destroyed.
SPECIAL refers to lesser demons and devils, powerful undead, etc. 1-2 such creatures will be affected. Creatures past 10th level or comparable will not be affected.

Clerics may cast from all Seven Levels of Holy Magic, depending on their level.

Spell Level	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Class Level	1-2*	3 4	5 6	7 8	9 10	11 12 13 14 15	16

3.33 Druids
Druids require a minimum Wisdom of 12, Charisma of 15 and must be "true neutral" in alignment. If both Wisdom and Charisma are greater than 15 the druid gains an additional 10% to experience earned.

Druids roll a d8 for Hit Points each level.

EXPERIENCE TABLE

up to 2,000	lvl 1
up to 4,000	lvl 2
up to 7,500	lvl 3
up to 12,500	lvl 4
up to 20,000	lvl 5
up to 35,000	lvl 6
up to 60,000	lvl 7
up to 90,000	lvl 8
up to 125,000	lvl 9
up to 200,000	lvl 10
up to 300,000	lvl 11
up to 750,000	lvl 12
up to 1,500,00	lvl 13
1,500,001 +	lvl 14

Druids are restricted to sickle, dagger, throwing knife, scimitar, sling or staff without using an extra proficiency - and may only use leather armor and/or wooden shields (bracers may be worn if of magical nature).

They receive one two points of Manna per level (plus Wisdom bonus, if any):

[Manna = 2 Points Per Level + Wisdom Bonus]

They start with 2 proficiencies, along with Herb Lore 3, Decipher Runes 2, History Lore, and Astrology.

Druids may Turn Undead (see Cleric table).

4.0 THE RACES OF TELRHIN

Players can run characters from any of the races below. Outside of these "player races" the world itself includes a variety of other sapient races, from lizardmen, kobolds, giants, ogres and gnolls to the Sindar and Nende elves and the Numener race of humans.

The Building Point cost for races reflects the Attributes gain (and losses) as well as natural abilities like infravision. A starting human character has no Attribute bonuses or special abilities but is left with more Building points to invest in skills.

RACIAL MODIFIERS & BUILDING COSTS

Elf (Sylvar)	Dexterity +1/Wisdom+1/Constitution -1	1,200 BP
Half-Elf	(none)	900 BP
Uruk-Hai	Strength +1/Constitution +1/Intelligence -1	1,500 BP
Uruk	Constitution +1/Intelligence -1/Wisdom -1	300 BP
Half-Orcs	Constitution +1/Intelligence -1	600 BP
Khazad	Constitution +1	1,750 BP
Haffer	Strength -1/Dexterity +1	600 BP
Human	Intelligence +1/Wisdom -1	0 BP

4.1 HUMAN PLAYER CHARACTER RACES

Humans get a bonus to their Intelligence to reflect their ingenuity, as well as an additional 100BP per level. They get a penalty to their Wisdom.

Westrons: this includes people like the Lowlanders, the Lark-Hanians ("Mir-folk") and the Ausgourdians. Westrons tribes are spread across most of the known world.

Vijmani: this is a Suthri/Westron mix, with some Araketi, mostly found in Vijmania.

Suthri: "Southrons" – includes the Akani Southrons (more Westron mix along with some Akani) and the taller Arnosians and tow-headed Dalmati.

Akani: these are the people from Akania, which includes several tribal groups with their own characteristics.

Shadisi: the people of Shadis

Araketi: Westron/Shadisi mixed people of Bardor and Araket, and including the nomadic Harik tribes

Khitagani: the general grouping of the continental peoples of Khitagan.

Pauronese: East Isles people, of a Khitagani background with some Westron mix

4.2 OTHER PLAYER CHARACTER RACES

ELVEN PEOPLES:

The Elven peoples are distant cousins to the Suthri humans, and include the Nendë, Sindar, and Sylvar races. PCs can only play as Sylvar – the background and world knowledge (and natural powers) of the Sindar and Nende make them unmanageable as PCs.

Elven ears are pointed (of course), their hair varies in color by tribe and includes silver; eyes are blue, brown, green, grey, hazel and gold. Elves need twice as much water as humans, and if they are deprived of sunlight they lose a point of Constitution per week (it comes back, but if they drop below 3 they'll be incapacitated and at 0 you die).

Sylvar [pl. & s.] (s. c`Wood Elves') average between 5'0" and 5'6". Sylvar are naturally quiet walkers and get a bonus +2 to Stealth rolls (if they don't have the skill they can still roll as though they have it at first level, but without the bonus). Sylvar have infravision 60'. Silvar can drink twice as much alcohol as any common man (roll all Alcohol Chugging at 2 levels higher). Like Sindar, Sylvar can attempt to detect good or evil alignments (once per day):

Good/Evil perception	lvl chk on d20

Sylvar add 1 point to their Dexterity and Wisdom, and subtract 1 from Constitution.

HALF-ELVEN PEOPLES:

Half-Elves get a +1 bonus to Stealth rolls, but don't get any special bonuses if they don't have the skill.

Half-Elves have a limited resistance to alcohol (roll all Alcohol Chugging at 1 level higher). Half Elves have infravision 50'.

Half-Southron: These half-elves tend to look a lot like Sylvar since Southrons share some of the same blood. The higher the Comeliness score, the more likely the half-elf will pass for elven.

Half-Westron/Khitagani/Pauronese/Akani: These half-elves tend to take after their human side and vary widely in features and build; because of certain cultural beliefs Half-Khitagani are revered in parts of Khitagan and Half-Westrons are looked on with suspicion in the Lowlands.

Half-Shadisi: These half-elves tend to be tall and combined with the ashen skin they aren't usually well received by elves because of the stigma associated with the mythic "dark elves" of the Nyrsë.

ORCISH PEOPLES:

Orcs rest in a period of hibernation; for every month they sleep for two-three days, needing only an hour or so each day otherwise. Orcs have very keen senses of smell, and their infravision has a broad color band that allows them to see in great detail in the dark; however in light they perceive the world in black and white like dogs, with difficult glare in sunlight that bleaches out detail and range (this varies by race as noted below). If they spent any time with traditional orc tribes, player characters will speak Orcish as well as a local common tongue.

> ***"It is certain, however, that (so far as Orcs went) the Uruk-hai were a far superior breed, being taller and stronger, with great endurance, and an altogether higher level of intelligence. For these reasons alone they were greatly to be feared."***
>
> ***J.E.A. Tyler, The Tolkien Companion***

Uruk-Hai [pl. & s.] (black speech. c`Great Orcs', s`Yrch', kh`Gorgûn', q`Glamhoth'): The Uruk-Hai are the stronger, larger orcs. They are the size of men, 5'8" to 6'0"; they have dark skin and sinuous bodies, as well as semi-pointed bestial teeth. Uruk-Hai have black hair and dark eyes, with rare cases of red as well. Uruk-Hai are not blinded by normal light, but have difficulty seeing in sunlight or bright lights. They have infravision 80', and live fairly long lives. Uruk-Hai add 1 point to Strength and Constitution, and subtract 1 point from Intelligence.

Detect slope in passage	60%
Detect new construction	70%
Detect shifting structure	20%
Detect stonework trap	20%
Determine approx depth	40%
Direction sense	60%

Uruk [pl. & s.] (black speech. c`Orcs', s`Sil-Yrch', kh`Sir-Gorgûn or Gorgun', q`Silhoth'): Uruks tend to be smaller (5'2" to 5'6"), with bowed legs and long arms. They have dark brownish grey skin, with protruding lower jaws and full teeth. Uruk have severely limited vision in the light, and are near blind in direct sunlight. Extended exposure to the sun will cause them to weaken; they lose 1 point of Constitution every month. Uruks have infravision 90'. Uruk add 1 to Constitution, and subtract 1 from Intelligence and 1 from Wisdom.

Detect slope in passage	60%
Detect new construction	50%
Detect shifting structure	20%
Detect stonework trap	10%
Determine approx depth	50%
Direction sense	75%

Half-Orcs: Half-orcs are cross breeds, and can pass for human if their Comeliness is 16+. For whatever reason Half-Orcs are usually Half-Westron. They are usually of Westron height, with light brown-grey skin and large jaws, black eyes and hair. Half-orcs add 1 to Constitution and subtract 1 from Intelligence. Half-orcs don't hibernate, but every month they need a good few days rest and tend to need less sleep at night; they have infravision 30'.

DWARVEN PEOPLES:

Dwarves have extremely good sight and touch; most dwarves suffer from mild agoraphobia that is aggravated by these abilities. They have a highly developed sense of depth, which may account for their general discomfort on open water.

Khazad [pl. & s.] (kh. c`Dwarves', s`Naugrim', q`Nogothrim'): Dwarves are 4'8" to 5'3", broad-shouldered with large feet and hands. Males have thick hair and beards (and body hair for that matter) usually brown or black, but it's not uncommon to see reds and tow-heads. Their eyes, however, are almost always dark to black. Khazad must spend double the normal cost in Building Points in order to gain the Riding skill outside . Khazad have infravision 60'. Khazad add 1 to their Constitution score. Unless they were somehow were raised outside their culture, Khazad speak the dwarven tongue of Khuzdul. Khazad add 2 to their Saving Throw vs Poison.

Detect slope in passage	75%
Detect new construction	75%
Detect shifting structure	40%
Detect stonework trap	40%
Determine approx depth	50%
Direction sense	50%

HALFLING PEOPLES (HOBBITS, HAFFERS):

(c. s`Periain', q`Perianath', kh`Kudukûn') Haffers have a highly developed sense of taste; as their physical make-up makes them poor swimmers, many of the have a fear of water. Haffers spend Building Points for the Swimming skill as though it were Tier 1. Haffers subtract 1 from Strength and add 1 to their Dexterity, gain a +1 to short bows and slings

Tallfellows are the tallest haffers, averaging four feet. Short and solid, with great thick feet with a shock of hair on it. They have light-colored skin and human hair and eye colors, with an abundance of redheads. Tallfellows have clumsy infravision 20ft.

Detect slope in passage	50%
Direction sense	75%

Stouts are stockier and average about 3'6". They have light skin (except for the Maladar Stouts who are actually brown skinned), with darker hair and eyes than Tallfellows. They also have big feet with hair on them. Stout haffers have infravision 30ft (which is a little more detailed and less clumsy than Tallfellows).

Detect slope in passage	75%
Direction sense	50%

"Although Orcs varied from tribe to tribe, they tended to be short, squat, and bow-legged, with long arms, dark faces, squinty eyes, and long fangs. Most Orcs...were weakened by the Sun, and all preferred the dark. They were skilled in tunneling, in making weapons, and in other practical skills; their medicines were harsh but extremely effective."

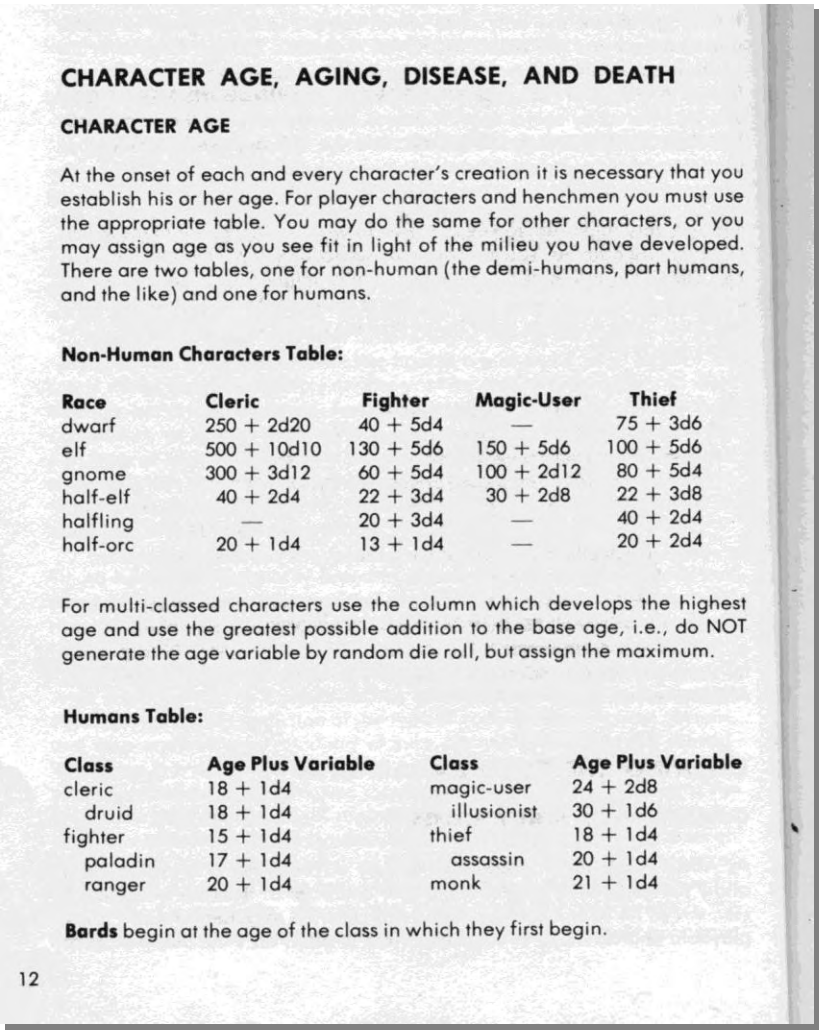
Robert Foster, <u>The Complete Guide to Middle-Earth.</u>

4.3 AGE CATEGORIES

RACE	YA	M	MA	O	V
HUMANS (all)	14-20	21-40	41-60	61-90	91-120
ELVES					
Sindar	45-150	151-500	501-800	801-1100	1101-1350
Sylvar	30-55	56-100	101-200	201-400	401-700
Half-Elves	24-40	41-100	101-175	176-250	251-325
HALFLINGS					
Tallfellow	22-33	34-68	69-101	102-144	145-199
Stout	22-33	34-70	71-110	111-155	156-210
DWARVES					
Khazad	40-60	61-175	176-275	276-400	401-525
ORCS					
Uruk-Hai	12-15	16-30	31-45	46-60	61-80
Uruk	10-13	14-25	26-35	36-45	46-60
Half-Orcs	12-15	16-30	31-45	46-60	61-80

4.31 Character Starting Age
Characters may choose the day and season in which they're born, but roll to determine age.

(for now we're using the starting age table from the old DMG p.12)



CHARACTER AGE, AGING, DISEASE, AND DEATH

CHARACTER AGE

At the onset of each and every character's creation it is necessary that you establish his or her age. For player characters and henchmen you must use the appropriate table. You may do the same for other characters, or you may assign age as you see fit in light of the milieu you have developed. There are two tables, one for non-human (the demi-humans, part humans, and the like) and one for humans.

Non-Human Characters Table:

Race	Cleric	Fighter	Magic-User	Thief
dwarf	250 + 2d20	40 + 5d4	—	75 + 3d6
elf	500 + 10d10	130 + 5d6	150 + 5d6	100 + 5d6
gnome	300 + 3d12	60 + 5d4	100 + 2d12	80 + 5d4
half-elf	40 + 2d4	22 + 3d4	30 + 2d8	22 + 3d8
halfling	—	20 + 3d4	—	40 + 2d4
half-orc	20 + 1d4	13 + 1d4	—	20 + 2d4

For multi-classed characters use the column which develops the highest age and use the greatest possible addition to the base age, i.e., do NOT generate the age variable by random die roll, but assign the maximum.

Humans Table:

Class	Age Plus Variable	Class	Age Plus Variable
cleric	18 + 1d4	magic-user	24 + 2d8
druid	18 + 1d4	illusionist	30 + 1d6
fighter	15 + 1d4	thief	18 + 1d4
paladin	17 + 1d4	assassin	20 + 1d4
ranger	20 + 1d4	monk	21 + 1d4

Bards begin at the age of the class in which they first begin.

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Age Effects on Attributes
Note that scores will not exceed 18 or be less than 3 unless the modified score was rolled naturally. Wisdom, however, may exceed 18 by this means no matter how the score was attained.
Modifiers are cumulative; starting at Mature includes the penalties and bonuses of having been Young Adult.

Young Adult:
Subtract 1 point Wisdom, add 1 point Constitution.

Mature:
Add 1 point Strength, add one point Wisdom.
Middle-Aged:
Subtract 1 point of Strength, Constitution and Comeliness; add 1 point Intelligence and Wisdom.
Old:
Subtract 2 points of Strength, Dexterity and Comeliness; subtract 1 point of Constitution. Add 1 point of Wisdom.
Venerable:
Subtract 2 points of Comeliness, 1 point of Strength, Dexterity and Constitution; add 1 point of Wisdom.

4.4 Height and Weight

Race	Avg	-	+	Male	Female
Dwarf	51	1-3	1-3	118 - 146 lbs.	107 - 133 lbs.
Elf (Sylvar)	63	1-6	1-4	90 - 112 lbs.	85 - 105 lbs.
Halfling (Tallfellow)	48	1-3	1-3	50 – 58 lbs	44-52 lbs
Halfling (Stout)	42	1-3	1-2	40-50 lbs.	36-46 lbs.
Human (Westron)	64	1-6	1-8	117 - 143 lbs.	108 - 132 lbs.
Human (Suthri)	68	1-6	1-6	139 - 169 lbs.	126 - 154 lbs.
Human (Akani)	66	1-6	1-8	128 - 156 lbs.	117 - 143 lbs.
Human (Vijmani)	68	1-6	1-6	139 - 169 lbs.	126 - 154 lbs.
Human (Shadisi)	70	1-6	1-4	149 - 183 lbs.	135 - 165 lbs.
Human (Khitagani)	66	1-6	1-6	128 - 156 lbs.	117 - 143 lbs.
Human (Araketi)	68	1-6	1-6	139 - 169 lbs.	126 - 154 lbs.
Human (Pauronese)	64	1-4	1-6	117 - 143 lbs.	108 - 132 lbs.
Uruk	60	1-6	1-6	95 - 117 lbs.	90 - 110 lbs.
Uruk-Hai	70	1-8	1-6	149 - 183 lbs.	135 - 165 lbs.
Half-Orc	(use human half)				
Half-Elf	(use human half)				

Height (d%):
1-30 under average, 71-00 over average. Then roll for variance.

Weight (d8):
1 = Extremely Thin, 2 = Very Thin, 3 = Thin, 4-5 = Average, 6 = Heavy, 7 = Very Heavy, 8 = Extremely Heavy.
Weight Modifiers: Add 1 to roll for every point of Strength above 15 (subtract 1 for Strength below 8). On a successful Constitution check adjust 1 category of your choice (failure means a penalty of 2 on the Comeliness check). On a successful Comeliness check adjust 1 category of your choice (failure = adjust 1 category towards the nearest extreme)

CHAPTER II: COMBAT AND MAGIC

1.O COMBAT

Summary

Combat is broken into 6 second “segments” (sometimes called a “combat round”). During that segment the character may be dodging, parrying and attacking all at once. The number of “attacks” a character rolls are a rough approximation when all of this is taken into account: the rules help frame the possible actions available each segment. And remember, during those same 6 seconds the enemy is doing their best to kill your character.

All of these actions are summed up with a Dexterity modifier for Armor Class (to explain dodging), To Hit bonus to explain physical and weapon skills, a target number to represent skill by class and level, and Armor Values to take into account how hard it is to actually hurt someone wearing armor.

> **"'Sblood *interj.* God's blood H5 4.8.9 *'Sblood, an arrant traitor...!*, HAM 2.2.366, HAM 3.2.369.**
> **-> Occurs several times in early Qq, but only once (H5 4.8.9 *'Sblud*) in Ff, in which a milder oath is sometimes substituted."**
>
> **C.T. Onions, *A Shakespeare Glossary***

Hit Points, Healing and Death

Hit Points are the character's life blood, and represent their ability to survive physical harm. Past 10 or 20, the HP total no longer reflects a literal total; an exceptional HP total symbolizes a heroic ability to endure, withstand and suffer blows that might harm a lesser man/woman (you know, peasants and redshirts). The blows might still knock them down, and certainly still hurt and bruise, but only on max or high damage rolls do they actually draw blood.

A character heals d4 HP per week's rest, or d6 for Con 16-18, d8 for Con 19-21, d10 for Con 22-25. Characters heal at double this rate when resting in stress-free hospitable conditions with no physical strain for the entire week. The Healing skill increases the rate (not to mention potions and spells).

Death: At -10 HP, the character has to make a Constitution check or die, and again at -15 with a minus 5 penalty (or just one roll at -5 if they go straight to -15). At -20 the character (what’s left of them) is dead.

At 0 the character is incoherent, and unconscious at -1. At 0 a Con Check may be made to utter a word or two, or get a glimpse of what is happening around.

Dying Action: Any character who goes from conscious to dead in one segment gets a final action. One swing, one toss, a few words. A spellcaster with a spell set to go off at the end of that segment can make a Con check to still get it off. This is in the vein of Hero Points, something reserved for Player Characters (and a few NPCs) to reflect their heroic nature.

Combat

Fighting is based on skill, speed and equipment. The standard fight is resolved as follows:

1 determine surprise (if any) or optional initiative roll
2 each character moves in order of MOVE
3 each character attacks in order of MOVE, using all of his/her swings
(optionally, especially if minis aren't being used, #2 and #3 can be combined)
4 armor value is subtracted from damage
5 spells functioning this segment go into effect
6 characters at 0 HP or lower are down and out of the fight

Surprise & Initiative: The DM may sometimes just flat out tell you who's surprised, but it will usually be determined by rolling your MOVE or less on a d6, d8 or d10 (die determined by circumstances). Surprised characters lose a round of actions. Initiative may sometimes be called for (d6 + MOVE) to determine turn order instead of just going by MOVE scores.

Character take actions in order of speed (individual combat MOVE score). Attacking is rolled on a d20, with attribute and magical bonuses added along with situation (see 1.1 ACTIONS & MODIFIERS and 2.1 COMBAT IN MOVEMENT). Unconscious characters will bleed to death if cut at the rate of 1 HP per round (1 minute) until they reach death at -10 HP.

> "**Combat** *v.*, **-bated, -bating** or (*esp. Brit.*) **-batted, batting**, *n.* **--***v.t.* **1.** to fight or contend against; oppose vigorously. **--***v.i.* **2.** to fight; battle, contend (fol. by *with* or *against*). **--***n.* **3.** a fight between two men, armies, etc."
>
> *American College Dictionary*, edit. Clarence L. Barnhart 1949

Movement Notes: If we're using minis, then all MOVE scores are based on 5 foot squares/hexes. Note the 'outmaneuvering' rules in Actions & Modifiers below as well a Winning/Losing. Generally speaking if a character's route takes them past another character they can attack. A maximum of 6 human-sized characters can surround a single character (using 1 handed weapons). To move past an occupied square/hex you'll have to fight through and either knock your opponent out (or prone) or 'win" the segment and force them back.

Combat Table

WARRIOR	CLERIC	ROGUE	OTHER	10	09	08	07	06	05	04	03	02	01	00	-1	-2	-3	-4	-5	-6	-7	-8	-9	-0
-	-	-	0-3	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	20	20	20	20	20	21	22	23	24	25	26	27
-	1-2	1-3	4-6	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	20	20	20	20	20	21	22	23	24	25
1-2	3-4	4-6	7-9	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	20	20	20	20	21	22	23	
3-4	5-6	7-9	10-12	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	20	20	20	20	21	
5-6	7-8	10-12	13-15	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	20	20	20	
7-8	**9-10**	**13-15**	**16-18**	**2**	**3**	**4**	**5**	**6**	**7**	**8**	**9**	**10**	**11**	**12**	**13**	**14**	**15**	**16**	**17**	**18**	**19**	**20**	**20**	**20**
9-10	11-12	16-18	19+	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20
11-12	**13-14**	**19+**		**0**	**0**	**0**	**1**	**2**	**3**	**4**	**5**	**6**	**7**	**8**	**9**	**10**	**11**	**12**	**13**	**14**	**15**	**16**	**17**	**18**
13-14	15-16			0	0	0	0	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16
15-16	**17+**			**0**	**0**	**0**	**0**	**0**	**0**	**0**	**1**	**2**	**3**	**4**	**5**	**6**	**7**	**8**	**9**	**10**	**11**	**12**	**13**	**14**
17+				0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12

Exempli Gratia:

> Vladsbogg [MOVE 3, AB 1] and Ramone [MOVE 5, AB 0], arch rivals and competitive thugs, decide to have it out in the alleys of Southwarren.

Round 1:
Vladsbogg draws his longsword and knife, but Ramone suspected this so he was unsurprised - he draws his rapier and dagger as Vladsbogg circles warily. Ramone gets his two swings first, missing both. Vladsbogg then gets 2 swings at +1, hitting with his longsword to Ramone's leg.

Round 2:
Ramone is forced back as he is losing the battle - he swings twice, rolling a 1 with his rapier, which he fumbles, but hitting with his dagger. Vladsbogg misses his two rolls.

Round 3:
Vladsbogg is now driven back, and Ramone takes advantage of this to jump on top of a crate. With disadvantage of ground, Vladsbogg is reduced to 1 attack; however, Ramone only has his dagger. Ramone, who is quicker, stabs out first - he rolls a 20 and then rolls a 10 on the Regular Crits table, which means he should roll a third time on the Special Crit Table as well as double the damage from his successful hit. He rolls a 17 on the Special Crit table, adds 1 for his level higher than Vladsbogg, which results in severing Vladsbogg's middle finger, forcing him to drop his knife. Vladsbogg then stabs out with his rapier, skewering Ramone who slumps dying to the ground.

ThAC0: This is a shortcut for calculating the number you need to roll to hit something ("To Hit Armor Class 0"). Look up what it takes to hit Armor Class 0 on the chart, then jot it down somewhere. Whenever you toll to hit, subtract the AC of the target from your ThAC0 (AC 6 is 6 easier to hit than 0, for instance) and that's what you need to roll. You still get any bonuses for Strength, Dexterity, skills or magic, so add that to the final number you roll.

"**Death** n. **1.** The permanent cessation of all vital functions in an animal or plant. **2.** The condition of being dead. **3.** *Usu. cap.* A personification of death, usu. a skeleton holding a scythe. **4.** The extinction of anything; destruction. **5.** The cause of dying. **6.** The time or manner of dying: to meet a tyrant's *death*. **7.** Something considered as terrible as death."
Funk & Wagnalls Standard Desk Dictionary, edit. Sidney I. Landau 1986

1.1 ACTIONS & MODIFIERS

Terminology

Opposed Roll: an 'opposed roll' is used to determine certain outcomes and has no other effect (like damage). The characters involved roll against Armor Class 10 and the character that makes it by the most wins. Unlike ability checks or straight level checks an Opposed Roll is about the fighting ability of the characters. In most rolls it doesn't matter if you fail to hit AC 0, what matters is if you get closer than your opponent. If you tie then the tie-breaker will be your class level, a skill level, an attribute or even your MOVE score, depending on the reason for the roll.

Winning/Losing the Round: the side that has inflicted more damage (total) then it has received is Winning. The Losing side can do nothing in its turn other than step 1 square back, turn to face another opponent, or flee (fleeing when Losing allows the other side to get its full set of attacks). The Winning side may press the attack (forcing the Loser back 1 square), or Leave the Battle without harm. To avoid being backed up off a cliff or into something painful, the Loser can

opt to stay their ground on a successful Opposed Roll – otherwise the only option is to either move back or take automatic damage from their attacker(s) the next segment. For purposes of Winning/Losing, the total damage is the amount before Armor Values are reduced, and there can be more than one person to a 'side'.

Size Modifiers

Large and giant humanoids have penalties when attacking smaller characters, and smaller creatures in turn have bonuses attacking larger creatures. For most melee attacks the modifier is 1 for every size category difference:

Huge (cloud & storm giants)
Large (ogres, trolls, most giants)
Normal (humans, elves, uruk-hai, dwarves)
Small (halflings, goblins, kobold)
Tiny (brownies)

Special Weapons, Damage and Rolls

Lances & Pikes: Characters wielding a lance or pike against an opponent with any other weapon (including pole-arms, spears, etc) automatically strike first unless they are outflanked. The opponent may not attack until the lance or pike has missed, at which point the longer weapon becomes useless.

Natural 20: A natural 20 always hits and damage (including modifiers for magic or Strength) is doubled. Optionally a character can choose to have an additional attack instead of double damage.

Natural 1: a one rolled will always miss. A level check is made to avoid rolling on the Critical Miss Table.

Brawling Damage: a victim may be taken to -20 with brawling damage, and heals 4 times quicker. [EX #1: Toad is sliced with a knife down to 1, and hit at the same time with a brawling attack by Mullox the Brute who takes him to -12. Even though the two blows were in the same segment, the 3 points that could've killed Toad were part of his brawling damage. Toad is in horrible shape regardless, and may even appear to be dead.]

Terrain and Cover

Advantage of Ground: opponent(s) get one less swing (minimum of 1), or else the fighter on higher ground has a +2 To Hit if the opponent(s) has only 1 attack to start.

Cover: melee attackers get one less swing (minimum of 1) or -2 To Hit if attacker only has 1 attack to start. For missile attacks, archers, etc., subtract 4 for full cover and 2 for half cover.

Special Actions

Leaving the battle: if engaged, then the opponent gets a free attack. However, the attacker may not move that segment if they choose to use their free attack (unless the opponent is Fleeing).

Fleeing the Battle: when an opponent is engaged and is Losing, they can Flee – but unlike Leaving the Battle their opponent not only gets a free full segment of attacks but can also move.

Surprise: surprised do not get the opportunity to attack, and can only move with a successful level check. Surprised characters lose any modifiers for Dexterity, shields or bracers.

Prone: Prone characters lose any bonuses to AC for shields, bracers, and Dexterity. Attacking from prone allows only one attack (or -2 if the character only has 1 attack). Rising from prone takes an entire segment (both Movement and Combat Phases), and during that segment the character fights and is struck as prone -- unless no one is attacking, which case s/he can get up during the Movement Phase and fight as normal during the Combat Phase. Any single blow inflicting half a character's remaining HP or more can send a character down (Constitution Check), counting as prone.

Changing Weapons: a character can opt to exchange a weapon instead of moving in the Movement Phase (if the they aren't Losing). Anything held in the new weapon hand must be dropped. If the character exchanges his/her only weapon s/he loses any normal 'to hit' modifiers (form Strength or Dexterity).

Re-Aiming: when re-aiming (changing targets), either with a missile weapon or a melee weapon, the character subtracts 1 for each re-aim. The penalty doesn't apply to melee weapons if the character opts not to move that segment.

Tripping: to trip an opponent make an Opposed Roll (this counts as an attack). If the defender is not moving out of their square this segment they get a +2 bonus. If they are running or charging they get a -2 penalty. Success results in the defender being Prone. Failure gives the defender a free regular attack. Some weapons (spiked chain, guisarme, halberd, whip) give a tripping bonus (usually +2) and prevent the defender from getting a free attack.

Charging: can't be engaged, double damage with an impaling weapon (lance, spear, javelin, spetum, etc). The defender can impale the charger with any planted stabbing weapons (pike, spetum, spear, halberd, guisarme, zweihander, etc) for double damage.

Blind Fighting: blind fighter is at -4 to hit and loses modifiers for shields, bucklers and Dexterity. No damage bonus for blind fighter. Attacks on the blind fighter are made at +4.

Overbearing: overbearing is an Opposed Roll. If the target is already prone, the attackers get a +4. For every additional person in the group trying to overbear, add +3 (and the character with the best roll makes the Opposed Roll).

Backstabbing: a backstab is an undefended attack from behind (for surprised victims see below). Backstabs are done with a +2 bonus (thieves and assassins get +4) and defender does not get to use a shield or bracer (but they still get their Dexterity bonus). The attacker also gets to add their level to the damage roll (thieves and assassins can opt to double to damage roll instead). Surprised victims: on a successful level check a backstab automatically hits; otherwise the attack gets an additional +2 and the defender gets no bonus for Dexterity to their Armor Class.

Specific Shots: aiming for a particular spot for any reason (including a shot to the hand to disarm) is made at a penalty of 2 (body & limbs), 4 (hands, held items) and 6 (specific fingers, eyes). A successful hit inflicts normal damage and a roll is made on the Hit Location chart - modifying the result by 1 towards the targeted part for every point beyond the number needed to hit. When attempting to force a drop or disarm, a successful shot to the hand adds +4 to the Opposed Roll (see disarming). A specific shot to the neck is possible (to cut a strap, remove a necklace, or just for the added damage of a neck shot) but a specific shot to decapitate is not. If a defender knows you're aiming for a specific spot then the modifier for the location on the Hit Location chart is determined by an Opposed Roll.

Targeting Sweet Spots (optional rule)
To add a little more strategy or realism, a specific shot can be made and then the number needed to hit

can be modified by the armor on the specific body part targeted (or animal part, etc). To keep this from being a player advantage, it can be offset by giving penalties (better AC) to the best protected parts, so a blow to an unarmored head that instead strikes the steel breastplate of the torso would not only roll against the main AC of the defender but at an additional penalty.

Disarming: if the goal is solely to disarm an opponent an Opposed Roll is made. This is the only attack that can be made this segment, however any additional attacks the character might have give a +2 bonus each. Defenders with weapons held in two hands get a bonus of 4. Attempting to disarm an armed opponent while unarmed can be done at a penalty of 4. Success: the target is disarmed (if the attacker was unarmed, they are now in possession of the defender's weapon). Failure: the opponent gets an additional attack.

Parrying: a partial parry allows a character to use their To Hit bonus to improve their Armor Class instead of using it for their attack(s). (e.g. a character with 2 attacks at +1 reduces their AC by 2).
For a full parry you forfeit all attacks but double Armor Class reduction. Additionally, you get a +2 per attack. (e.g. someone with 2 attacks at +1 reduces their AC by 8). Modifiers for a full parry: small shield = 2, medium shield=3, great shield=4
Parrying is only effective against as many opponents as you have attacks (a shield allows 1 more)

Chasing: striking an opponent while on a full run reduces the number of attacks by 1 (or a penalty of 2 if the character only has 1 attack). For every unsuccessful attack the attacker's MOVE is reduced by 1 the following segment. The attacker has to be able to match the speed of the defender to attack (however, if the difference is only 1 the attacker can do a single lunging attack and land prone the next segment). See also Tripping and Overbearing.

Outmaneuvering: (during combat) characters competing to reach a specific place make an Opposed Roll and add their combat MOVE score. Unobstructed characters who are not engaged will reach the spot in order of their running MOVE score. If the goal is to block a character from passing: as long as the blocker is able to intercept the target during the movement phase an Opposed Roll is made and combat MOVE is added. Winning or Losing will determine the options on subsequent rounds.

1.11 Multiple Opponents

Using one handed weapons, as many as 6 opponents may attack a single person (surrounding them).

Using two-handed weapons or fighting two-fisted the number drops to 4. Morning stars and pole arms drop it to 2. Size difference is modified by 3 per category: a small defender may only be attacked by 3 medium opponents, or 1 giant opponent; 12 small attackers could engage 1 giant defender (10 with two-handed weapons, and 8 with morning stars or pole-arms).

Attacking more than 1 opponent can be done if the attacker has enough attacks or rolls a *Natural 20*; see 'Re-Aiming' under Actions & Modifiers above.

Note that should attackers be attempting solely to *overbear*, then double the number of attackers (treated as using one handed weapons) may attack an opponent.

1.12 Other Adventuring Situations

As much as fighting and stabbing is central to any good game of hack-n-slash, you do sometimes find yourself doing other things. Like haggling, drinking, or stealing. Most of these things have an associated skill. This is for the rest.

Searching for Secret or Concealed Doors
Generally speaking, secret doors are doors that are made to look like something else: a blank wall, a book case, a false floor. Concealed doors, on the other hand, are just doors or passages hidden behind a curtain or under a rug.

10% + INTELLIGENCE + CLASS LEVEL + TRAPS SKILL

Dwarves add 15%, elves and orcs add 10%, haffers and half-orcs 5%

This is a percentile roll based on a round (minute) of searching. The Success Chance is doubled for concealed doors. Prolonged searches (10+ rounds) get a bonus 10%, and for concealed doors if it really is under a rug or behind a curtain anything other than rolling 100 makes it.

1.2 CRITICAL HITS & FUMBLES

Critical Hits
A natural 20 on the attack die is a critical hit. The attacker has three choices: double the damage, opt for an additional attack, or go for a Vengeful Blow.

Double Damage: The damage roll, after all modifiers have been added, gets doubled.

Additional Attack: Instead of doubling the damage you can get an additional attack with that same weapon.

Vengeful Blow: As a third option, you can choose a spiteful shot aimed at scarring, damaging or embarrassing your opponent.

- **Scarring**: your opponent gets a scar unless they can magically heal within minutes or have some regenerative powers. The severity of the scar is determined by the damage roll, but it can be wherever the player thinks they could have hit given the weapon and circumstances.
- **Damage**: you can damage either the armor or weapon of your opponent. Armor will give them 1 less to their AC and a weapon will work as minus 1 to hit and damage (usually noted as "-1 craft"). Magical armor and weapons won't receive a penalty but will show a visible dent or scratch (depending on the damage roll).
- **Embarrassment**: this is a non-strategic effect, so the result won't apply to magic items or cause any penalties, but you can cut off jewelry, chop their cloak off, cut off their ponytail, cut their clothing to make their junk hang out, you name it.

Hit Location Chart
The Hit Location chart can be used to determine where the blow landed when a random result is needed. Unless you are using the optional 'Targeting Sweet Spots' rule the outcome is only for descriptive effect.

Modifiers: Natural 20s get +2. Heavy blows that knock an opponent down (but aren't Natural 20s) get +1. Level Difference: +1 for every 2 levels more than the target (2 levels = +1, 5 levels = +2, etc).

HIT LOCATION CHARTS (d12):

Main Hit Location Chart

1. Hand
2. Foot
3. Forearm
4. Lower Leg
5. Upper Arm
6. Thigh
7. Shoulder
8. Chest/Back
9. Chest/Back
10. Gut/Kidneys
11. Groin/Butt
12. Head

Fumbles

A 1 on the attack die always misses. A successful level check results in a simple miss, but a failed check means a fumble (or worse).

Critical Miss Table (Failed Level Check)

Missed By	**Outcome**
1	Weapon dropped at feet!
2-3	Weapon lost, flies in random direction d6 feet
4-5	Weapon lost, flies in random direction d6 feet, all subsequent attacks lost
6-7	Roll to hit random other person within range (if none, then it's you! No mods)
8-9	Roll to hit random other person within range (if none, it's you! Yes modifiers)
10-11	You fall prone and drop everything!
12-13	Weapon lost, flies in random direction d12 feet (to hit at +4), fall prone
14-15	Weapon lost, stunned for rest of this and all of next segments
16-17	Automatic damage (no modifiers, just weapon die) on self, fall prone
18	Automatic damage (with all modifiers) on self, fall prone
19	Automatic double damage (with all modifiers) on self, fall prone

Notes:

From 5 on all **subsequent attacks are lost**.

16 on opponent gets **immediate free attack**.

Flying weapons that land in another square/hex that's occupied roll to hit, normal rules apply (non-proficiency penalties for thrown sword, etc)

1.3 PROFICIENCIES

Proficiencies are simply the training in the use of a weapon. Think of them as specialized skills just for weapons. Most weapons require only one slot to learn, except certain two-handed weapons such as a katana and weapons with special functions.

Starting number, added proficiencies per level and non-proficiency penalty:

Class	Starting	Level	Penalty
Warriors	4	4,7,10	-2
Thief/Bard	3	5,9	-3
Assassin	4	5,8	-2
Mage	2	1 per 4	-4
Cleric	3	1 per 4	-2
Druid	2	1 per 4	-3

- **Shields**, **bracers**, and **bucklers** do not require proficiencies, unless they are used offensively.
- **Knife** proficiency does not include Throwing Knives.
- **Bows** or **Crossbows require 2 proficiencies** but includes all forms in each category; (the Archery Skill requires a specific type of bow or crossbow to be chosen). You can spend just 1 proficiency on bows or crossbows instead of 2 but the firing rate is halved.
- **Bracers** require a proficiency if used in conjunction with TFF to lower AC by 3.

1.31 Two-Fisted Fighting (TFF)

A special proficiency called Two-Fisted Fighting lets characters fight with a weapon in both hands. Sure, you can do that already, but you can only attack with one weapon at a time. Two-Fisted Fighting lets you have an extra attack every other round. The second attack comes on the second round, and the order of attacks is "main weapon then second hand weapon" (e.g. "sword/dagger"). This requires a proficiency in addition to the proficiencies required to use the weapon(s) in the first place. The second weapon has to be a dagger, short sword, buckler or hand axe. You need a good Dexterity to avoid any penalties:

Penalties for Two-Fisted Fighting	
Dex 15+	0
13-14	-1
11-12	-2
10	-3
9 and below	-4

Two-Fisted Fighting combines with additional attacks that some classes gain at higher levels. A Fighter with 3/2 attacks who has Two-Fisted Fighting would get 2 attacks every round.

Weapon speed modifiers don't apply when fighting Two-Fisted (consider that the penalty for trying to wield two weapons at once).

[exempli gratia: Karrig Elfcrusher uses a longsword in his preferred hand, and a dagger in the other; he used 1 proficiency for the longsword, 1 for the dagger and 1 for the Two-Fisted Fighting proficiency. On the first round of combat he swings with the longsword, on the second round he swings with longsword AND the the dagger. As a fighter, once he is high enough level to gain 3/2 attacks, he would swing with his longsword followed by his dagger each round.]

This proficiency, due to its agile nature, requires no armor beyond studded/padded leather to be worn (or magical armor of equivalent encumbrance); otherwise the character checks his penalty on the chart above with a penalty of 2 to his dexterity for every armor type beyond studded/padded leather.

1.3X Shield Proficiency

Shields can be used as weapons with the Shield proficiency for d6 damage, and any fumbles by opponents give you an immediate free shield attack. Shields can also be "weaponized" with spikes or sharp edges to make damage d6+1.

1.32 Two Handed Weapons

Using a two-handed weapon without penalties requires a strength of 15.

Penalties for Two-Handed Weapons	
Str 15+	0
14	-1
13	-2
12	-3
11 and below	-4

Characters with a 19+ strength and 5'10"+ in height may wield hand-and-a-half swords (mandoble, bastard, etc) in one hand causing two handed damage. Characters with 20+ strength and 6'+ in height may wield two-handed weapons in one hand for one die lower damage (d12 becomes d10, etc). Characters with 21+ strength and 6'2"+ in height may wield two-handed weapons in one hand for full damage.

1.33 Long Blades and Race Size

Races in the 'small' size category (like Halflings) can't use long bladed weapons like longsword, broadsword, bastard swords, and most two-handed weapons that have long blades or shafts. Some two-handed weapons can be made with short shafts (battle axes) but others lose their 2-handed weapon value since the impact is reduced with the shorter swing (2-handed mace). Weapons with chains like morning stars aren't restricted and long stabbing or impaling weapons can at least be used in the first round of engagement.

Exceptions for Abilities: to overcome the height/space issue a high strength and dexterity can reduce the penalty.

Penalties for Small Category races (Combined Strength+Dexterity)	
36+	0
35	-1
34	-2
33	-3
32 and below	-4

"As they say, the harder they fall the harder they get up. Armor is such an amusing thing."
Guildmistress Fallen Rasdy

1.4 ARMOR VALUES
The chart below lists various common types of armor and indicates which body areas they cover. Shields count as full body cover (because they're mobile).

Armor absorbs some of the damage before it penetrates. The Armor Value is absorbed per segment of combat total, whether the character was hit once or ten times. Breath weapons (dragonfire, etc), magic, lightning, magical fire, etc aren't reduced, and neither is falling damage.

1.41 Partial Armor (optional rule)
Partial Armor functions as follows; the total number of points of armor worn is subtracted from base 10, and this new number becomes a character's Armor Class (AC). When a blow is scored, hit location is determined and appropriate Armor Value (AV) is subtracted from the damage roll.

Leather armor is only capable of turning away slight or weak blows, and is recorded as `0/1' for its AV; this means that any blow inflicting only 3 points of damage total (before any AV from shield is deducted) will allow the leather AV to be equal to 1 - however blows dishing out more damage are considered heavier and unlikely to be stopped by leather, and so the AV then is 0.

Armor Type	Points	AV
Shield (all)	1	1
Leather Shirt (body)	1	0/1
Sleeved Leather Shirt (body and arms)	1	0/1
Leather Coat (body and legs)	1	0/1
Sleaved Leather Coat (body, arms, and legs)	2	0/1
Leather Coif (head and neck)	1	0/1
Mail Shirt (body)	2	1
Sleeved Mail Shirt (body and arms)	3	1
Mail Coat (body and legs)	3	1
Sleeved Mail Coat (body, arms, and legs)	3	1
Mail Coif (head and neck)	1	1
Normal Breastplate (body)	2	1
Full Breastplate (body)	2	3
Plate or Mail Arm Cover (arms)	1	2/1
Plate or Mail Leggings (legs)	1	2/1
Helmet (head)	1	2

Full Helm (head and neck)	2	2
Plated Boots + Gauntlets (feet and hands)	1	0

Bucklers modify AC [see 5.3 WEAPON DATA], as well as Dexterity.

For the purposes of rules comparison, all combinations count as the most favorable equivalent full suit of armor of same Armor Class value.

1.42 Complete Armor

Complete Armor follows a simpler system; if however, a character loses a piece of armor or adds to his complete armor, it becomes Partial Armor as listed above. The shortcoming of this system is that it does not take into account specific areas, and generalizes the Armor Values.

Armor	Armor Value
Shield	1
Ringmail, scale mail or chain mail	1
Splint and better	2

Armor Class is rated as follows:

None	10
Leather or Padded	8
Studded Leather or Ring Mail	7
Scale Mail	6
Chain Mail	5
Splint Mail, Banded Mail or Bronze Plate Mail	4
Plate Mail	3
Field Plate Armor	2
Full Plate Armor	1

Shields and Bucklers modify AC [see 5.3 UNUSUAL WEAPONS], as well as Dexterity.

1.43 Armor Penalties

Skills such as *Pick Pockets, Locksmith, Find/Remove Traps, Stealth, Shadows, Noise, Climb, Acrobatics, Blind-Fighting, Brawling,* and *Swimming* are penalized when used while armor is worn.

Penalties with minus symbols are deducted from the success chance; a penalty without a minus indicates the number of levels below normal the character functions.

Magical armor counts as 1 class below its actual class, plus 1 more for every plus of its power, and 1 more for every special power it bestows; so +5 Full Plate becomes Scale Mail.

Skill	Leather	Studded/Padded	Ring	Scale	Chain	Splint/Band	Plate Mail	Plate Armor
Pick Pockets (ac)	-2	-4	-6	-8	-12	-10	-14	-12
Locks (a)	-1	-2	-2	-2	-2	-4	-4	-4
Traps(abd)	-5%	-10%	-25%	-40%	-45%	-60%	-100%	-120%
Stealth	-2	-4	-5	-6	-10	-8	-12	-14
Shadows	-2	-2	-4	-5	-5	-8	-10	-12
Hear Noise (b)	-	-	-1	-3	-5	-5	-8	-6
Climbing (a)	-4	-6	-8	-10	-12	-16	-20	-22
Acrobatics(a)	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
Blind-Fighting(b)	-	-	-	1	2	2	3	3
Brawling	-	-	-	-	-	-	1	1
Swimming (ab)	1	2	3	5	7	8	12	14

[a]Assumes gauntlets are removed
[b]Assumes helmet is removed
[c]Includes Pilfer skill.
[d]Includes Traps skill.

1.5 MOUNTED COMBAT

1.51 Jousting
The Joust is the famous competition of Knights. The rules vary depending on the tournament, some of these listed in the Field Guide to Telrhin. When the object is to dismount the opponent, then whenever damage occurs the Skill Check is invoked "to fall off in strenuous circumstances", in which an 8 will always fail. Note that in some jousts a dummy tip called a *mouche* is added to the lance, inflicting only 1 point [plus Strength and then doubled for charge]. [Note the *Lances & Pikes* rule under 1.2 THE BATTLE.]

1.52 Charging Beasts
If mounted on a creature able to charge or trample [EX: Giant Ram], then no attack may be made by the rider that segment unless he is over 10th lvl in Land Riding for that mount. In this case, a one handed weapon may be employed prior to 17th lvl, and from then on both hands may be employed. Note that this rule does not apply to regular attacks from a non-charging mount.

2.0 RATE OF MOVEMENT and CHARACTER 'MOVE' SCORE

For modifiers to character travelling rates afoot, refer to the second edition *Dungeon Master's Guide*© pp122-126 and the *Wilderness Survival Guide*© p32 for other beasts of burden (note that the rates in the WSG are per *half* day, not full day).

Movement Afoot in Miles/Day

Burden	**Normal Terrain**	**Rugged Terrain**	**Very Rugged**
Light	30	20	10
Average	20	10	5
Heavy	10	5	2

Movement Mounted in Miles/Day

Mount	**Normal Terrain**	**Rugged Terrain**	**Very Rugged**
Light	60	25	5
Medium	40	20	5
Heavy	30	15	5
Draft	30	15	-
Cart	25	15	-
Wagon	25	10	-
Carriage	30	10	-
Chariot	35	15	-

Ships and Water Travel: most ships on the Valek are built for cargo and only make around 5 knots an hour, and that's not taking into account the unpredictable and often violent weather of the Valek. The 2 scores for **Miles/Day** are for rowing/sailing.

Movement on Water in Miles/Day

Boat	**Miles/Day**	**Crew**	**Cargo**
Rowboat	8/18	1	100cu ft
Barge	12/30	8	1800cu ft
Galley	18/50	120	2000cu ft
Galleon	10/72	120	3500cu ft
Scooner / Fast Sail Boat	0/80	30	2000cu ft
Small Cargo Ship	0/70	20	3000cu ft
Medium Cargo Ship	0/80	35	8000cu ft
Large Cargo Ship	0/90	50	12000cu ft

CHARACTER 'MOVE' SCORE
Your character's MOVE determines the order in which they attack and is used to help determine surprise and initiative. There are two MOVE scores, the COMBAT MOVE and the RUNNING MOVE.

Base COMBAT MOVE is determined by adding Dexterity and half of Intelligence (rounded up). And don't forget Encumbrance (p.47) and weapons speed modifiers.

Dex+½Int	Com. Move
<7	1
07-14	2
15-22	3
23-25	4
26-31	5
32-38	6
39-42	7
42+	8

Modifiers to Combined Dex + ½ Int Total:

Halflings and Dwarves	-3
Strength 17 or more	+1 for every point above 16
Low Strength	-1 for every point below 5
Wisdom 17 or more	+1 for every point above 16
Low Wisdom	-1 for every point below 5
Characters over 7'	+3

Base RUNNING MOVE is determined by combining Strength and Dexterity. And don't forget Encumbrance.

Str + Dex	Run. Move
02-10	1
11-21	2
22-29	3
30-34	4
35-39	5
40-43	6
44-47	7
48-50	8

Halflings and dwarves subtract 5 from their combined STR + DEX total, characters over 7' add 3 to theirs.

Endurance
The RUN MOVE has a second number to indicate endurance, equal to half the character's Con score; this number determines how many segments a humanoid character can Sprint without being winded enough so as to affect his MOVE. After that time, his current MOVE is reduced by 1, and then another 1 every time. Note that the second

number is variable in the case of Creatures, likes horses, etc.

[EX: The Halfling Kiwi has a base RUN MOVE of 2, and a Con of 13. His RUN MOVE Score is thus 2/7. Sprinting from a Bulette with MOVE 5/6, his current MOVE of 6 will only last for 7 segments until it is reduced to 5. The Bulette, however, has a current MOVE of 15 which can last for 6 segments. Kiwi dies horribly.]

In the above example, both creatures could have chased one another for 6 segments before the Bulette got winded. However, in that time, the Bulette would have traveled 90 squares, and Kiwi only 36 squares.

2.1 MOVEMENT IN COMBAT

1. To fight another creature, the character or attacker must be in adjacent squares (6 ft), unless their weapon is 6+ ft, in which case they may be 1 square away. An attack may be made at 1 square away by a 5 ft weapon if a dexterity check is made before hand for each strike.

2. A character may attack anyone who is within the above stated range within any part of a given segment, so long as his weapons were drawn and in hand at the top of the segment.

3. If an opponent is drawing or exchanging weapons during the movement phase of the segment, a character may opt to move away - only those within the above stated range for the second half of the moving character's path may strike him, or characters within range of any part of his path so long as they were armed at the top of the segment, as above.

4. A *losing* character(s) may never strike his opponent if the opponent chooses to disengage and move away.

Modifiers:

Sprint (without attack)	**:** move x 3
Retreat (with attack)	**:** half move
Charge (with thrusting attack)	**:** move x 2
Charge (with chopping attack)	**:** move + half

2.2 ENCUMBRANCE

Encumbrance occurs when Splint/Banded Armor or bulkier is worn (non-magical), more than four swords/large weapons are carried (three for dwarves, two for haffers), or when over half of a character's Max Press (see Strength) is carried in addition to Armor (one third for haffers).

Magical armor counts as 1 class below its actual class, plus 1 more for every plus of its power, and 1 more for every special power it bestows; therefore a powerful suit of full plate could theoretically have the encumbrance value of leather.

Encumbrance	**MOVE**
Heavy Armor	**:**-1/-1
Lots of Arms	**:**-1/-0
Too Much Weight	**:**-0/-2

Exampli Gratia: a haffer in plate mail, bearing a longsword, a zweihander and a siege arbalest, carrying 70 lbs of equipment, would be at -2/-3. An orc with the same Strength and carrying the same equipment would be at -1/-3, and if that orc has a 12+ Strength s/he'd be at -1/-1.

2.3 JUMPING AND CLIMBING, AND FALLING DAMAGE

Characters who don't have skills like Acrobatics or Climb should refer to the *Dungeoneer's Survival Guide*© pp14-19 (adding character MOVE total to the jumping formula), or the *Wilderness Survival Guide*© pp33-39. Falling Damage is equal to 1d6 HP for every 10 feet fallen and is not absorbed by armor (note that rogues reduce damage by 1 for every level).

3.O MAGIC

The source of magic is the Aigrim, a great flowing ocean of power called the 'spine of the world' in the old Lowlanders tradition, and considered by some covenants to be remnants of the creation forces that made the world. Mages draw this power through rituals, usually in the form of spells, elaborately crafted and refined over the centuries; this is called Ritual Magic. Holy men are granted their powers directly from their gods, pulling the celestial forces through the Veil from the divine worlds (the Listar, Myrgbon and Orindus). Not covered here is Eldar magic, which pulls from the Second World and Spirit Worlds.

Spellcasting Note: For every 10 points of manna (or when they reach 0) a spellcaster exerts they are consider 'winded' (Move -1: see ENDURANCE under MOVE).

"Sorcery is nothing to my axe." -- Grorkin Minehard

3.1 HOLY MAGIC

Holy Magic doesn't require a roll to cast (unless your Wisdom is low). The caster invokes the power from their god(s) who then channels it through them. The spell takes effect at the end of the Casting Time. A 1 segment spell is cast during the Movement Phase of the melee segment, and takes effect at the end of the segment during the Combat Phase. If a spellcaster is disrupted (takes damage, is forcibly moved, or heavily distracted) before the end of the Casting Time, the spell does not work and the Manna is lost. Also, if a Success Chance is required (for low Wisdom) and the roll fails, the Manna is lost.

Casting requires a Holy Symbol. Casting without one doubles the Manna cost.

Success Chance: Spellcasters with low Wisdom scores have to roll against a Success Chance (listed under Wisdom).

Spellcasting Modifiers:

+2 for Holy Magic if on Holy Ground.
+1 for Druids if both feet are on natural ground
+1 per five levels, starting at 5th

After every full night's rest Manna is replenished [up to 5 points plus class level per night].

Holy magic does not require memorization and any spell known to the caster can be used at any time (assuming they have the Manna for it). Any verbal commands must be read with authority, and any material components are spent (consumed) unless stated otherwise. Most Holy spells require the holy symbol to be held aloft.

Manna Cost: Spells cost 1 point of Manna per level of the spell.

3.2 RITUAL MAGIC

3.21 Using Ritual Magic

Spellcasters spend the necessary Manna and then roll against their Success Chance to case. The spell takes effect at the end of the Casting Time. A 1 segment spell is cast during the Movement Phase of the melee segment, and takes effect at the end of the segment during the Combat Phase. If a spellcaster is disrupted (takes damage, is forcibly moved, or heavily distracted) before the end of the Casting Time, the spell does not work and the Manna is lost. If the Success Chance roll fails, the Manna is lost.

Success Chance: Half Intelligence + Class Level. Unlike skills, an SC of 20 or higher (after modifiers) always succeeds.

Spellcasting Modifiers:

+1 if Mage is in own lab
+1 for Specialist Mage casting from own school
+1 in non-stress (non-combat) situation

Spellcasters can learn a lot about magic cast by others on a roll of half their SC or less. Spellcasters are also aware of the powers of their own spells and recognize any spells cast that they themselves know (and would know they had been *charmed* once such a spell wore off).

A spellcaster regains half their strength after every night's rest [up to 5 points of Manna + spellcaster level].

Grimoires: Mages need to keep a written set of instructions for each spell, usually gathered together in a book of spells called a grimoire. Grimoires are magical in nature and hold not only the instructions and component lists for each spell but a magical "key" that allows the spellcaster to maintain mastery. A mage has to review their spells regularly to maintain their knowledge (reviewing takes 10 minutes per level of the spell and can be done at any time within a month of casting). Without a grimoire, or if more than a month has passed since the spellcaster has had a chance to review a spell, the manna cost is doubled. Unless a mage has access to special powers and resources, they can only keep one copy of a spell due to their magical nature, though they can transfer spells from one book to another. If they lose their grimoire, they can continue to cast (at double the cost) until they can spend the time and resources to create a new grimoire (which is time consuming and lower level mages would need the help of a mage with the power to do it (the "write scrolls" ability)).

Spellcasters can cast any spell in their grimoire as long as they have the Manna to cast it. Any verbal commands must be uttered with authority, and all material components are spent (consumed) unless stated otherwise.

Manna Cost: spells cost 1 point of Mann per level of the spell.

The casting requires at least one of the following enchanted items in addition to the spell itself:

A staff or similar item to channel the magic.
A talisman or brooch, etc.
A robe or hat.

These channeling tools are known as 'cowlings' among spellcasters. Casting without a cowling doubles the manna cost.

Mages may cast from all schools of magic, or they may specialize as outlined in the Mage class description and below.

Specialist mages such as Abjurers, Conjurers, Diviners, etc follow the rules on school restrictions and other modifiers, and add +1 to their SC when casting from their specialized school of magic.

All magic-users may employ Lesser Divination, which includes all Divination spells of 4th Level or less. There are 8 Schools of Magic in all, as follows:

The 12 Schools of Ritual Magic
Abjuration
Alteration
Conjuration/Summoning
Enchantment/Charm
Greater Divination
Illusion/Phantasm
Invocation/Evocation
Necromancy

Note that Ritual magic is tightly tied to the spellcaster; thus if a spellcaster is incapacitated, any magics they might be controlling dissipate and cease to function.

3.3 OTHER MAGICAL POWERS

Alchemy
Alchemy is a magical science with a basis in chemistry. The recipes and formulas for potions have to be collected like spells, saved in phylacteries. A lab is required, the more elaborate the better the Success Chance. The ingredients are costly and the process is time consuming. Much of this will be based on GURPS 4th Edition rules.

Protective Circles and Pentagrams
Circles and Pentagrams are loosely based on the old skills of the same name. To be developed later.

Recharging Staves
Details to be developed later.

Creating New Spells
This will likely follow the suggestions in the 1st Edition DMG. To be developed later.

Impermanent Magic
Many spells and powers have a temporary effect, but some forms of magic are impermanent by nature (such as faierie Glamour) and many of the Illusion spells. In practice Impermanent magic is only real to the beholder: they aren't actually on fire, their friend isn't actually resurrected (just an animated meat puppet) and they aren't really walking on water. They can be brought to 0 Hit Points by perceived injury, but unless other circumstances are in play they will not die from impermanent magic. If they believe there's a bridge over the canyon, they can fall to their deaths; they can drown under water thinking they are walking on top of it; and many other fun ways to die. Lastly, Impermanent magic is usually "manna dependent" and needs to be maintained: when the source goes away or stops feeding it manna, it dissipates.

3.4 SCROLLS

Scrolls have a chance of failure if the scroll was written by someone other than the reader.

1. Reader is not a spellcaster - Intelligence check. You need to be literate in the language of the spell, which usually requires the Decipher Runes skill since magicians tend to use rare "magical" languages.

2. Spellcaster but not enough Manna to cast a spell of that level: [missing manna]% failure. Manna isn't required to use a scroll, but having it ensures success.
3. Spellcaster but not able to cast spells of that level: 2% chance of failure per level.

Note that #2 and #3 are cumulative, but if the chance can never drop below the equivalent chance for an Intelligence check.

The fabrication of scrolls also requires special inks, parchment and quills (refer to the second edition *Dungeon Master's Guide* pp85-87 for details). When written, the spellcaster has the option to veil the scroll's writing in magic. If such is done, then only Mages and high level thieves can read it.

"His head exploded, but other than that it went fine"

3.5 LOCKING AND MANNA

Everyone has a certain amount of manna, as rated by Manna Points. To determine this number for non-spellcasters, divide Wisdom by 6 and add level divided by 3 (rounding off) (the total must be a least one).

[W/6 + Lvl/3]

Non-casters regain up to 2 points for every full night's rest.

Spellcasters can use this raw form of magic as a minor spell (similar to the Allmagic); if a quill were dropping, the character could exert a little force to stop its fall. The quill would respond to the power affecting it and either slow, stop or rise, dependant on how much Manna is exhausted. In a sense, spells are simply the most efficient way of controlling power - words, a gesture and the streamlined task is performed - while with raw Manna, great concentration and a lot of energy is used to perform a clumsy job. The general rule is that a raw use of Manna this way takes 5 times the points of an equivalent spell. And it can't duplicate complex spells, just basic spells that affect the environment.

Locking is a mental battle may be held between two or more persons. An opportunity for this occurs when:

1/Conflicting spells meet [EX: *Knock* and *Hold Portal,* a fire-based spell and a water-based spell, etc]
2/Two spellcasters concentrate on one another, creating a mental link.

In the first case, if anyone involved opts to Lock, than everyone else must also. In the second case, both participants have to actively seek to engage one another.

<u>WHEN LOCKING:</u>
A deck of cards is used. Each one involved determines the amount of Manna they wish to exert; for each point they use, they are given an ascending card in one of the four suits (♥ ♦ ♣ ♠), starting with the 2. Then all parties shuffle their cards and draw one randomly; the winner inflicts damage on his opponents based on the difference in cards x d6. Note that when spending more units than there are cards in the set, one starts to eliminate the lower cards from one's hand; face cards cannot be eliminated, but additional ones may be added, drawn randomly.

Locking takes 2d4 segments, and is the classic wizard battle. The amount of energy spent is so great and intense in its conflict that it causes a variety of peripheral effects, mostly harmless. The closer the cards, the greater the struggle. Lights will flicker, temperatures will change subtly, static electricity will build up, animals will feel uneasy and react - and most visually, a variety of illusionary images will play ghostly between the spellcasters, symbolizing the magical struggle as perceived by the right side of the brain. A cliché example is the white pegasus battling the black manticore as a black and white warlock duel.

[EX: Pipi and Archmage Girgor Von Hell lock. Pipi spends his four points which gives him cards 2, 3, 4, and 5 of Diamonds. Girgor spends 20, getting 2 through Ace of Spades, and then discarding 2 through 8. As they shuffle, Pipi has 2-5 of Diamonds and Girgor has 9-Ace of Spades. They shuffle and draw: Pipi shows a 5 and Girgor shows a Jack. Pipi loses by 6, receiving 6d6 HP damage.]

When engaged, Spellcasters are encircled by a static force which makes them difficult to approach (Str Chk) and bestows them with AC -10 from normal missile weapons, adding +4 to Saving Throws from Area Effect spells (including such spells from wands, staves or rods) but not from direct target spells (such as Magic Missile). All damage sustained from missile weapons or spells is divided among the casters who are locking as they are joined together by the energy of the Aigrim.

If a Spellcaster sustains more than ¼ his total HP in damage from external forces, or is physically moved (tackled, shoved away, etc) then he loses concentration.

Loss of Concentration Chart During Lock:

ROLL	RESULT
1	Battle ceases, with no victor; Manna spent (wasted)
2	Spellcaster loses by random amount, up to 100% difference
3	Battle ends instantly, outcome determined normally
4**	Spellcaster spends random number of extra Manna and the outcome is determined based on new number of SP, ending at reg. time
5-6	No effect
7*	Spellcaster blasts everyone around him/her:Manna X 10ft diameter Manna X d6 dmg (dice divided among victims)
8	Spellcaster loses horribly – s/he and all touching him/her take damage equal to opponent's Manna X d6 (divided among them)

*In the case of #7 above, there is no victor and the battle ends then, and the SP in question is wasted by both parties.
**In the case of #4 above, the additional SP spent may be up to 100% of total remaining.

3.6 MAGIC ITEMS & POWERS

Invisibility
Invisibility comes in several forms. Sometimes referred to as 'shading', it is different than the elven 'dimming' power which only obfuscates the dimmed person in the mind of the seer. Invisibility (in most cases) actually pushes the subject into the Veil, even if it's only at the very edge of the Veil.

Since light can't be made invisible once it leaves the source, a character holding a torch can go invisible, but the light will still be seen, just not the torch itself. With magical blades that glow, or spells which cause dweomers, Type 3 invisibility can cover the light.

Characters should be careful what they touch - a character leaning against a wall with Type 3 invisibility will cause a hazing of the wall; also, thick dust, straw or flour on the floor can give a character away.

Invisibility has four main categories:

> Type I has a limited duration and is usually broken by fighting or casting spells. A shadow is cast by sun or moon light. Infravision can detect it within 5 feet and with an Intelligence roll at 10 feet (a passive roll, the person looking does not need to be searching or trying to look for an invisible person).
> Type II has no limit on duration, but shadows are still cast. It can't be detected by Infravision.
> Type III casts no shadow and cannot be seen by Infravision.
> Type IV is identical to T3, except that it can only be detected by means of Dust of Appearance or equally powerful items and high level spells.

Note that high level and intelligent creatures have a chance of detecting invisibility (there's a chart in the section on Intelligence).

Faierie invisibility sometimes pushes the subject into the Second World instead of the Veil. For the most part it behaves like Type 3 invisibility. However, fairie magic is often illusory, relying on tricking the mind of the victim, and this form of invisibility is actually obfuscation and varies based on the spell or power being used, and sometimes allows a Saving Throw.

Rings
Magical Rings usually radiate magic, and/or have moon or sun (or fire) letters engraved on them. Most rings are unique but their properties may usually be found through research. No more than 2 magical rings may be worn on each hand, otherwise the effects of the rings begin to develop erratic and potential dangerous effects. Certain magical items allow more rings to be worn, such as Overmyer rings; but in any case, no more than eight magical rings total may be worn.

Items of Protection
Rings, Cloaks, and Bracers do not necessarily work in conjunction with one another, nor with armor and/or magical armor. We are still following the old *Dungeon Masters Guide* rules for this.

Bags of Holding
Bags of holding usually work by reaching into the Veil where a small "space" has been created to store and hold the contents. Reaching into the bag and imagining a stored item summons it into the hand, so only the object is crossing into or out of the magical space. Living objects will die in the transition, so although food could be stored there an animal couldn't. Some people say it changes how things taste, and the magical space is usually not 'stasis' so items will continue to rot and age (as if contained in a dry cupboard). There are exceptions to all of these norms, and some bags reach into the Second World rather than the Veil, and follow different rules often unique to each bag. And some bags literally reach into a dry cupboard somewhere.

Infravision
Infravision allows the character to see in the infrared spectrum. Objects and creatures radiate a certain degree of heat which is seen as different colors - red for hottest and blue for coldest. Infravision does not give clear pictures and is very sensitive to fluctuation: a sudden flame will temporarily blind infravision, as will ice in an otherwise hot environment. Infravision is almost useless in fog or water, and can't see through glass. You can't read with infravision unless the runes are engraved or of a different substance than the background. Races described with "clumsy" infravision have a narrow range of colors, seeing only large variations in heat, and would have a hard time noticing engraved runes or even distinguishing between people of the same race.

Sight
Sight is the ability to peer into the Veil and see things for what they are. It generally allows a person to see the true form of creatures and objects, see through illusions and even detect invisibility. Sight as a power is ranked from 1

to 10, each level granting the seer one more step through the Veil (as well as a better success chance). Though characters may not know it, invisibility is usually achieved by entering the Veil, each invisibility type taking the character 1 step further into it (invisibility can also be created through illusion, which does not send the character into the Veil). Sight also allows characters to read auras.

Auras
Auras are ephemeral indicators of associations with gods, spirits, magic and the supernatural. They don't reflect ambiguous or general things like alignment. A priest or paladin might have an aura of their god figure, but not necessarily an aura of good (or evil) as well. A curse would leave an aura. Being part of some epic event, like the Fall of Talanasron (think Troy), might leave an aura. The Renegades would have a ton of fascinating auras, the killing of gods and mythic beasts, associations with immortals and epic quests. The Rahman brothers, at low levels, developed a weak faie aura because of some interactions with fairies. And of course there may be ways to mask or fake auras…

Insubstantiability
There are several ways for a creature or object to become insubstantial, and different limitations to what they can perform while insubstantial (and what they can interact with or be harmed by). Spirits and ghosts can achieve insubstantiality because they only partially exist in the living world, remaining a few steps into the Veil towards the Spirit World. Some forms of insubstantiality exist solely in the living world, and these forms are usually more vulnerable to the living world, able to be harmed and unable to completely remove themselves (beyond the possible ability to become unseen or felt). Insubstantiality through illusion is just that, and not real. Other possible limits to insubstantiality include a requirement to move on land and pass through doors like a living creature, inability or limitation in assuming corporal form, day/night restrictions or other event-based limits, limits to location (unable to leave a certain building or area), inability to touch or interact with the physical world, and vulnerability to items or magic (cold iron, holy items, light, etc).

4.0 SAVING THROWS

Saving Throws are used to avoid the effects of magic, poisons, breath weapons and scrolls/wands, etc. There are three categories, Natural/Holy, Magic and Poison. The total score is modified by Intelligence (Magic), Wisdom (Natural/Holy) and Constitution (Poison). Note that Paladins have +2 bonus to all Saving Throws.

Natural/Holy: breath weapons, divine powers, most undead powers, and holy magic.
Magic: ritual magic, staves, wands, most offensive magical items, ritual glyphs, etc.
Poisons: poison, venom and other non-magical, non-supernatural toxins.

BASE NUMBER = HALF LEVEL + ONE THIRD CONSTITUTION OUT OF 20
(add these together then discard remainder)

Modifiers by Race:

Race	Natural/Holy	Magic	Poison
Haffer	0	+2	+1
Dwarf	+1	-1	+1
Human *	0	0	0
Elf	-1	+1	0
Orc	+1	-2	+1

* Human includes half-orc and half-elf

"To see the Sun shining as I come out, knowing that my Life is there; to feel my Heart beating as the Darkness fades behind me, my pack jingling beneath its weight of gold; to know that I am alive; these are the things I hope for when I plunge into the depths of every Dungeon."

Lord Gorgon Redragon, c3113n

5.0 WEAPONS

From one side of the Realm to the other, you are bound to run into every kind of weapon that has ever existed. It depends entirely on the location of your character. In terms of the game, weapons do a set die amount of damage, plus Strength bonus. To wield them you need a proficiency, and some require more proficiencies than the regular; this applies only to special weapons or ones with multiple uses.

5.1 BOWS AND CROSSBOWS

Bows and crossbows followed by an asterisk (*****) may be fired while mounted (with the standard penalties under the Riding skill, if applicable). Bows and crossbows require TWO proficiencies (with one proficiency a character can use the weapon at half the firing rate). Proficiency covers the whole category of either bows or crossbows.

5.11 Bows

Bows vary in their performance (and availability). The common bows are listed below by culture. All bows fire at a rate of one arrow per segment.

bow	type	length	mass	range	dmg
empire bow (Destin)	self	1.4m	.6kg	90m	d4
shadis bow (Wilds)	comp	1.2m	.7kg	130m	d6
karangi bow (Grasslands)	comp	1.1m	.7kg	120m	d4
valek bow * (Lark-Han)	comp	1.0m	.8kg	150m	d6
khitagan bow * (Rakshem)	built	2.1m	.9kg	90m	d6
long bow (Dalmatos)	self	1.8m	.7kg	90m	d6
short bow * (Borderlands)	self	1.2m	.6kg	90m	d4
uruk bow * (Ugar)	backed	1.0m	.5kg	70m	d4
stone bow** (Zhân)	self	1.7m	.7kg	45m	d4

****This bow fires lead bullets only.**

***** May be fired while mounted

5.12 Crossbows

Like bows, crossbows vary greatly; however, it is based more on purpose than culture and technology. Most crossbows will be found in Zhân, Dalmatos, Ausgourd and Lark-Han.

xbow	type	mass	range	shots/seg	dmg
siege arbalest -windlass	steel	8.2kg	80m	1/5	d12+1
heavy arbalest -windlass	steel	7.0kg	65m	1/5	d10+1
heavy arbalest* -cranequin	steel	6.0kg	55m	1/3	d10+1
heavy arbalest* -screw & handle	steel	7.5kg	60m	1/5	d10+1
medium arbalest* -goat's foot	comp	3.8kg	50m	1/3	d8+1
medium arbalest -claw & belt	backed	0.7kg	40m	1/3	2d6+1
medium arbalest -cord & pulley	backed	0.7kg	40m	1/3	2d6+1
light arbalest* -cord & pulley	wood	3.4kg	40m	1/3	2d4+1
slurbow* -cranequin	steel	0.6kg	50m	1/2	d8+1
stone arbalest*	steel	0.7kg	30m	1/2	3d4+1

***** May be fired while mounted

> ***"The first important battle won by the use of hand firearms was Bicocca in 1522. From that event dates the decline in the use of armour in the field. The increasing efficiency of firearms made it impossible to make armour proof in every part, and mobility, the alternative form of defense, was impossible to achieve in ponderous armour."***
>
> ***Esey Norman, Arms and Armour***

5.2 FIRE ARMS (optional rule)

These weapons are extremely rare, and more often suicidal than effective. Discovered by the dwarves, these tools work on gunpowder, known as Hâdsh (kh. c`Blackfire'). The difficulty in keeping the hâdsh dry and weapon oiled, along with the scarceness of the hâdsh itself, perpetuate the rareness of this nasty toy.

There is a SC for a successful shot, based on the level of craftsmanship out of d8. Under non-stressful situations, reloading with an extra 2 segments will ad +1 to the SC roll.

For reload time, that is the number of segments required before being able to shoot; X segments and then shoot - a 1 sg reload time would not mean a shot every segment.

All fire arms may be shot while mounted, with the penalties as listed under the Riding skill.

name	craft	weight	range	damage	reload
pistol	1-7	2lbs	30m	1d12	3sg
rifle	3-7	8lbs	50m	2d6	4sg
blunderbuss*	1-6	10lbs	20m	2d8	2sg
doorblaster	1-5	12lbs	5m	2d12	8sg
knightfeller**	2-7	8lbs	20m	2d8	7sg
bomb***	0-5	2lbs	throw	3d4	-

*This weapon has a wide dispersal range, and can hit two targets if they are within arm's length at 5yrds, and within two squares (10ft) at 20yrds. It may also be loaded with anything at hand, ranging from rocks to a live chicken - the more preposterous the cargo, the higher the die rolled for SC.
**This weapon fires 2 pound metal spikes. Armor value is not subtracted from damage.
***This is a fragile container or pottery, glass, etc, filled with hâdsh and a wick. It's lit and tossed - with rather unpredictable results.

5.21 Bogey Table
When the SC Roll is failed, then another d8 is rolled on the Bad Results Table.

#	EFFECT	RADIUS	DMG
1	no effect	0	0
2	no effect	0	0
3	misfire, hâdsh wasted	0	0
4	misfire	1'	d2
5	misfire	5'	d6
6	misfire	5'	d8
7	explosion - SC or gun ruined	10'	d10
8	explosion - SC or gun ruined combustibles ST vs fire	15'	d12

Heavier powder weapons were the first to be implemented successfully (many dwarves later). Those on ships include 18 pound bow chasers, 24 pounders, 42 pound carronades, and longer range 32 pounders. When supported by a structure and mounted on walls, they can become as large as 5,000 pounds. The dwarven cities in the Ophir Mountains of Numedia are rumored to be defended by such guns, concealed in the mountainside overlooking the ascent to their gates. Dwarves also developed the steam cannon, but this device is said to be less effective despite its lower risk. Among the other races, the Western Isles are often defended by cannons to protect the harbors, such as Malinas in the West Isles.

"Since fighting and wars are the arts we trade in,
We must have a little and short cannonading,
Our guns must be fired at a distance but still,
With no wicked intentions to wound or to kill."
English Sailor's Song, 1756 AD

"Tritus fills our sails with breath,

And we our foes we fill in death -
Cruel winds they love us wickedly,
Throwing our ships most deliciously -
And so we fight the roaring sea today,
For life we live, come what may."
Destinite Sailor's Song, 220n

5.3 WEAPON NOTES

Weapon damage follows 1st Edition AD&D unless noted here. Generally that means a short one handed weapon (short sword, hand axe) does d6 damage, a long one handed weapon (long sword) does d8, and a two handed weapon does d10. Hand-and-a-half swords can be used in either one hand for d8 damage or two hands for d10.

Arrow. Common, many varieties.
(dmg by bow / Special Crit Table: #20=19, #18=8)

Buckler. Bucklers are used in Two-Fisted Fighting instead of a second weapon. They're used to block and guard the bearer, but can't be used to attack. Takes a proficiency, and only good vs melee weapons.
(armor class + three)

Full Helmet. A Full Helm is the sign of any self-respecting knight.
(armor class + .5 / reroll (once) Special Crit 19, 17, 15, 13 / negate garotte)

Gauntlet. Mail gauntlets can be used to strike an opponent, either in regular combat or with the Brawling skill. This weapon does not require a proficiency to wield.
(d4 dmg per gauntlet / reroll Special Crit #8 & 18)

Claymore. The great sword of Ausgourd.
(two-handed / d10 dmg / Regular Crit +1)

Garotte. Fine wire with thumb rings. Only on backstab. Victim, once hit, must either inflict damage or overbear the attacker to break hold, or else receive automatic damage.
(two handed / d10 dmg)

Great Axe. A favorite among dwarves, this is a long shafted axe with a big ass blade.
(two handed / d10 dmg / Regular Crit and Special Crit +1)

Hand Axe. A short handled single-bladed axe, may be used in Two-Fisted Combat and thrown for short distances (30ft, add Strength bonus to damage at 10ft or less).
(d6 dmg)

Katana. The katana is from Khitagan. This is a hand and a half sword that can be used in one hand if a second proficiency is spent.
(hand and a half d10 dmg OR one hand d8 dmg, d10 with extra proficiency)

Knife. Poignard, dagger, deergutter, etc (not a throwing dagger).
(d4+1 dmg / can't be thrown)

Mailed Boot. A kick with a boot adds to the damage of the kick. This can be done in regular combat or with the

Brawling skill. Steel toecaps work the same way. This weapon does not require a proficiency to wield.
(kick damage) +1 dmg/crit roll reroll 18-20

Mandoble. This is the Bastard Sword of the Westrons, and may be wielded in one or two hands.
(hand and a half d10 dmg OR one hand d8 dmg)

Parrying Dagger. This knife has a very wide hilt or special blade with prongs to help trap the weapon of the opponent.
(d4 dmg /+1 bonus when used to parry)

Rapier. This weapon is all the rage in the courts of Dalmatos. Quick and light, best against unarmored opponents.
(combat MOVE +2 / double armor values / d8 dmg)

Shields

Small Shield. A Small Shield defends against up to 2 opponents.
(armor class + 1)

Medium Shield. Shields can be slammed into the opponent for damage and to knock them off balance (you need a weapon proficiency in shields or else get a non-weapon proficiency penalty). All other attacks must be forfeited, as the whole body is used in the shoulder thrust. A Medium Shield lowers AC only versus 2 opponents. Note that spikes can be added for +1 damage.
(1 attack only / d6 dmg / opposed roll to knock opponent back, knocked opponent rolls at -2 next round / armor class + 1)

Great Shield. Like a Medium Shield, a great shield may be used to attack an opponent, with the same rules. In addition, a great shield can strike 2 opponents (if they are side-by-side and the shield is wielded with both hands), and lowers AC against 3.
(1 attack only / d6 dmg / opposed roll to knock opponent back, knocked opponent rolls at -2 next round / armor class +1½)

Shortsword. Shortswords are fast and perfect for Two-Fisted Fighting and a good stab.
(combat MOVE +1 / d6 dmg)

Throwing Knife. This is a lightweight knife for throwing. Range is short (40 ft). These tools can be used as a dagger, also.
(d4 dmg thrown or thrust)

Two Handed Scimitar. This is a Shadisi weapon, a rare two handed variant of the Araketi and Shadisi scimitars.
(two handed / d10 dmg)

Zweihander. A Semtrean weapon, can be planted and used against a mounted charge.
(two handed / combat MOVE – 2 /d12 dmg / Special Crits +1)

Weapon	Hand	Dmg	AC	MOVE	Crit
Arrow	-	**	-	-	20=19, 18=8
Axe, Great	2	d10	-	-	+1 both rolls
Axe, Hand	1	d6	-	-	
Buckler*	1	-	+3	-	
Claymore	2	d10	-	-	+1 to make
Fist	1-2	d2	+1	-	
Garotte	2	d10	-	-	
Gauntlet	1-2	d4	+1	-	Reroll 8 & 18-20
Helm, Full	-	-	½	-	Reroll 19,17,15,13
Katana	1	d8	-	-	
(katana)	1½	d10	-	-	
(katana)	1*	d10	-	-	
Knife, Dagger	1	d4+1	-	-	
Knife, Parrying	1	d6	-	-	
Knife, Throwing	1	d4	-	-	
Mailed Boot	-	+1	-	-	Reroll 18-20
Mandoble	1	d8	-	-	
(mandoble)	1½	d10	-	-	
Quarrel	-	**	-	-	20=19, 18=8
Rapier	1	d8	-	+2	
Shield, Great	1	d6	+1½	-	
(great shield)*	1½	d8	+1½	-	
Shield, Medium	1	d6	+1	-	
Shield, Small	1	-	+1	-	
Shortsword	1	d6	-	+1	
TH Scimitar	2	d10	-	-	
Zweihander	2	d12	-	-2	+1 on table

*Requires an additional proficiency
**Damage and Range by bow or xbow type

"She should have died hereafter;
There would have been time for such a word."
Macbeth, V.iv.17-18



CHAPTER III: TRAINING AND SKILLS

"Blood should sprinkle me to make me grow."
Richard II, V.vi.46

1.0 TRAINING, EXPERIENCE & GAINING LEVELS

At the end of each gaming session the DM will hand out Experience Points. Experience Points (which is a running total) are used to go up in your class level but can also be spent to increase your skill levels. What gives you experience? Killing things and loot, of course. The bigger the better, with magical items being the single best way to score experience. You also get points for creativity and roleplaying, but that's no way for an adventurer to make a living.

As long as characters have reasonable exposure and opportunity to learn new skills or proficiencies, or progress in the ones they already have, most class levels and most skills advance automatically as soon as the character spends the necessary points.

Class Levels
If your new Experience Total is enough to put you into the next level, congratulations. You will get to roll for additional hit points and you may gain new Proficiencies, Skills or additional attacks. All of this is covered in the description of your character class. Some classes may require training or initiations at certain levels. Once your Experience Points have been put towards your class level, they can no longer be spent on anything else.

New Skills
New skills can be purchased with Building Points:

Tier 1 Skills: 500 points
Tier 2 Skills: 250 points
Tier 3 Skills: free

Tier 1 and 2 skills begin at Level 1. Tier 3 skills are free and everyone has them, starting at level 0.

After the initial character creation process, new skills can only be learned by gaining new Building Points at higher levels (there are other means, either through artifacts and in-game events, as well as 'crossover' skills at higher skill levels).

When adding a new skill after character creation, the character needs to have some exposure and opportunity to learn the new skill: adding the Riding skill after many fumbling trips on horseback, for instance. Adding Herbal Lore, however, would require some means of learning it.

Increasing Skill Levels
Skills can be increased by spending Experience Points or Building Points.

Tier 1: 300xp x New Skill Level
Tier 2: 200xp X New Skill Level
Tier 3: 100xp x New Skill Level

Before you buy up a skill (increase its level), you have to roll a d20 and get a number higher than your current skill level. If you fail, you can't buy up that session. You may get a 1 to 3 modifier if you used the skill frequently and with good effect (and a penalty if you barely used it or didn't use it at all). If you are purchasing more than 1 level of increase, the

bonus only applies to the first roll (but penalties apply to all rolls). Note: this does not apply to character creation – new characters can increase skills without rolling if they have the Building Points to do it.

Once you purchase a new level you automatically advance for most skills (some skills might require training/mentoring). Just check to see what's changed at the new level and make the appropriate notes on your character sheet. Some skills grant "crossover" skills at higher levels as well, and these are also automatically attained.

2.0 SKILLS IN STAB & PILLAGE

Skills help round out a character. They also let characters develop outside the narrower "template" of their class. Unless otherwise noted, a skill is initially gained at level 1 except for Tier 3 skills that always start at level 0.

The base Success Chance of a skill is based on an attempt at "average" difficulty, rolled on a d20 for most skills.

Difficulty	Modifier (d20)	Modifier (%)
Impossible	-10	-50%
Extremely Hard	-5	-25%
Very Hard	-3	-15%
Hard	-1	-5%
Average	0	0
Easy	+1	+5%
Very Easy	+3	+15%
Extremely Easy	+5	+25%
Childlike	+10	+50%

Defaulting to other Numbers: some skills will indicate a default difficulty: e.g. "defaults to Very Hard". This means the initial formula is modified by that difficulty to determine the "average" roll. Defaulting to Very Hard, for instance, means the skill base success chance is calculated by halving the appropriate attribute, adding the skill level, then subtracting 3 (for Very Hard). This number is now the base roll. Like other base success chances, it can be modified by the difficulty chart above when used.

Building Points by Class:

Class	Starting	Progression
Fighters:	2	250 per level up through 6, then every other level
Paladins/Knights:	3	250 every 2 levels (2nd, 4th, 6th, etc)
Rangers:	2	250 per level up through 6, then every other level
Thieves:	2	250 per level up through 8, then every other level
Assassins:	2	250 per level up through 6, then every other level
Bards:	4	250 every 2 levels (2nd, 4th, 6th, etc)
Mages:	3	250 per level up through 8, then every other level
Clerics:	2	250 every 2 levels (2nd, 4th, 6th, etc)
Druids:	2	250 per level up through 8, then every other level

In addition, all characters get 100 Building Points times their new level (at 5th level you get 500 additional Building Points).

A Proficiency can be traded for 500 Building Points (but not vice-versa).

Note that unless noted otherwise there is always a chance of failing a skill check, no matter the Success Chance.

The number [in brackets] is the skill tier.

The attribute listed next to a skill is the base for the Success Chance. Some skills also allow a character to add their Class level or other modifier. And some skills use their own formula for their Success Chance. If there is more than 1 attribute listed the player can choose either unless stated otherwise.

Half the Attribute + Skill Level

CROSSOVER SKILLS: This is a benefit of certain skills; GAIN/ADD means the character gains the skill or adds a level to it if they already have it, and GAIN means that the character only gains the skill.

Class Restrictions: a couple of skills (Traps and Tracking for instance) are restricted to certain classes. Does this mean only a ranger or druid could ever track? Only thieves and assassins can possibly identify traps? For practical purposes, yes. But this doesn't mean there aren't exceptions for specialty classes like Hunter, Barbarian or Dungeoneer that aren't covered here, and there would be professional job skills that would allow hunters and trappers and general woodsmen to track, and craftsmen and builders to spot and possibly disarm traps – just not for PCs (other than playing a specialty class).

ACROBATICS [Tier 1] (DEXTERITY)

LVL	TIGHTROPE	POLE VAULT	HIGH JUMP	BROAD JUMP: STAND	RUN	TUMBLING: EVASION	FALLING
1	60%	8'	3.5'	4.5'	8.5'	5%	1
2	70%	9'	4'	5'	9'	10%	2
3	80%	9.5'	4.25'	5.5'	9.5'	15%	3
4	85%	10'	4.5'	6'	10'	20%	4
5	90%	10.5'	4.75'	6.5'	10.5'	25%	5
6	95%	11'	5'	7'	11'	30%	6
7	100%	11.5'	5.25'	7.5'	11.5'	35%	7
8	100%	12'	5.5'	8'	12'	40%	8
9	100%	12.5'	5.75'	8.5'	13'	45%	9
10	100%	13'	6'	9'	14'	50%	9
11	100%	13.5'	6.5'	9.5'	15'	52%	10
12	100%	14'	7'	10'	16'	54%	10
13	100%	14.5'	7.5'	10.5'	17'	56%	10
14	100%	15'	8'	11'	18'	58%	10
15	100%	15.5'	8.5'	11.5'	19'	60%	10
16	100%	16'	9'	12'	20'	60%	10
17	100%	16.5'	9'	12'	21'	60%	10
18	100%	17'	9'	12'	22'	60%	10
19	100%	17.5'	9'	12'	22'	60%	10
20	100%	18'	9'	12'	22'	60%	10
dwarf	-5%	-2'	-1'	-2'	-3'	+5%	-
elf	+10%	-	-	-	-1'	+5%	+1
1/elf	+5%	-	-	-	-	-	-
haffer	-	-2'	-1'	-1.5'	-4'	+10%	-

See: 1.3 ARMOR VALUES for penalties while wearing armor

Tightrope Walking across a 60' distance no steeper than 45°, at a rate of 60' per round. Hands must be free; a balancing pole improves effort by 10% - Non-Acrobats perform at base 20%, at a rate of 30'.
Pole Vaulting includes any jumping that uses something like a pole. 30' running head start is

needed, with a pole at least 4' taller than the vaulter.
Jumping: for a running jump a space of 20' is required. All jumping numbers have a character's base MOVE added.
Evasion is a chance to avoid 1 swing, blow or missile weapon; a separate roll is made for each, up to 3. Nothing else can be done that segment.
Falling is the number subtracted from the damage roll from any fall. If no damage occurs, then the acrobat may be on his/her feet next segment (this benefit is not cumulative with the Rogue ability to subtract damage from falling).

ACTING [Tier 2] (CHARISMA)
Ability to perform representational art
Add level to any lying rolls (including detection rolls)
CROSSOVER: ADD +1 per 5 levels to GUILD SIGNS, HAGGLING, COMMUNICATION, GAMBLING

ANIMAL NOISE [Tier 2] (INTELLIGENCE)
Ability to mimic (and recognize) animal sounds

ANIMAL TRAINING [Tier 3] (WISDOM)
CROSSOVER: AT LVL 5, GAIN/ADD ANIMAL NOISE

ARCHERY [Tier 1]
This skill applies to one specific type of bow or crossbow studied.

01 add 1 point to damage
02 fire from mount w/out penalty while stopped
03 extend range 3 meters
04 shoot as though Dex were 1 higher
05 extend range 10 meters
06 3/2 attacks
07 add 2 points to damage
08 add half STR bonus to damage
09 shoot as though Dex were 2 higher
10 fire from mount w/out penalty while riding
11 fire from airborne mount half penalty/ add 3 points damage
12 extend range 20 meters
13 add full STR bonus to damage
14 fire from airborne mount no penalty
15 add 4 points to damage
17 2/1 attacks

CROSSOVER: USE SKILL AT HALF LEVEL FOR OTHER TYPES OF BOW OR XBOW

ASTROLOGY [Tier 2] (WISDOM) (DEFAULTS TO VERY HARD)
Ability to decipher omens and predict the future; ambiguity decreases with increased level
At level 5, astrologer receives Nature Sense (tell alignment) at 1 foot. Increases at 1 foot per level thereafter. At level 10 character receives “saw it coming!”: re-roll one roll each session.

BLIND-FIGHTING [Tier 1]
Ability to fight without being able to see

1st; penalty To Hit at half
4th; damage bonus at half
7th; no penalty To Hit
9th; shield/buckler may be used effectively
11th; damage bonus at full

CROSSOVER: BRAWL AT HALF BLIND-FIGHTING LEVEL

BRAWLING [Tier 2]
Brawling is the classic ability to reek havoc in bars (or your living room, neighborhood dungeon, whatever) and is essential to all gaming in any good ol' fantasy world. Brawlers get one attack to start, doing 1-2 points + strength bonus damage.
Brawlers attack using their class attack column at their brawling level
Important note: brawlers using classic brawling tools such as broken bottles and crockery, barstools or chairs fight at one level higher.
Important Note 2: the RCM ("really cool move") can only be performed once you've already successfully popped your opponent at least once.

01st level: 1 attack
02nd level: Once per fight, can do "really cool move" for d6 dmg
04th level: Replace one attack with a kick for d4
06th level: 3/2 attacks
09th level: stun on 20 / Kick for d6
11th level: stun on 19/20 / Kick for d8
14th level: 2 attacks / Kick for d10
17th level: "doubles" 18-20 / Kick for d12

"doubles" indicates that an additional damage die is rolled, and if doubles are scored, then another is rolled, and so on.

"...And so Og, standing some distance below the dwarf, knocked him out of his boots and through the window some thirty feet away. `WOW!....Some doubles HE rolled!' muttered a bystander."
From Glouster's Tales of the Renegades

CARNIVAL GEEK [Tier 2] (CONSTITUTION)
Ability to perform bizarre acts
The Carnival Geek is a circus performer, using whatever physical abnormalities to entertain, or perform seemingly abnormal actions, feats, etc.
+1 bonus for every point of Charisma below 6 or above 15/ +1 for every 2 points of Comeliness below 8
CROSSOVER: ADD HALF LVL TO JUGGLING SKILL

CHARIOTEERING [Tier 2] (DEXTERITY)
Ability to drive a chariot

1st; can drive a simple chariot
2nd; can drive a race chariot
3rd; can drive a battle chariot
6th; can add 1 to chariot move rate
8th; can drive with one hand and fight with other at -2

10th; no penalty on fighting
12th; 2 in 6 of saving chariot from wrecking
14th; add 2 to move rate
16th; 1 in 4 of causing opponent to wreck (takes both hands)
17th; 3 in 8 of causing opponent to wreck
18th; 4 in 6 of saving chariot from wreck
19th; 4 in 8 of causing opponent to wreck
20th; MASTER CHARIOTEER add 3 to move rate, 3 in 4 of causing opponent to wreck.

CROSSOVER: AT LVL 7 GAIN/ADD HORSE RIDING 1.0

CLIMBING [Tier 1] (DEXTERITY) (ROGUES ADD CLASS LEVEL)
Ability to climb walls; average difficulty assumes there is purchase

Dwarves subtract 1, haffers subtract 1, and orcs add 1.

COMMUNICATION [Tier 3] (INTELLIGENCE)
Ability to communicate with intelligent creatures without a common language

CRAFTSMANSHIP [Tier 3] (INTELLIGENCE OR WISDOM)
Ability to construct tools or useful items from the environment

DECIPHER RUNES [Tier 2]
Studies to decipher unknown runic systems and/or tongues
Note that two rolls must be made if the runes and tongue are both unknown.

LEVEL	01	02	03	04	05	06	07	08	09	10	11	12	13	14	15	16+
%	00	01	03	20	25	30	35	40	45	50	55	60	65	70	75	80

Add 1% per point of Intelligence over 13; Rogues and Mages add class level to percentage chance.

DISGUISE [Tier 2] (INTELLIGENCE) (ASSASSINS ADD CLASS LEVEL)
Assumes use of a kit, otherwise it default so Hard or Very Hard depending on what's lying around. A full make-up desk/closet costs around 100gp and defaults to Very Easy. A portable kit costs around 40gp.

DRINKING ("ALCOHOL CHUGGING") [Tier 3] (CONSTITUTION)
Ability to down strong drinks (separate for each alcohol type)
add lvl to Saving Throw for special drinks
ordinary drinks equal to level may be had before intoxication is determined
CROSSOVER: OTHER CHUGGED DRINKS AT HALF LVL

ETIQUETTE [Tier 3] (WISDOM)
Training in social skills
Note that this skill is a separate skill for each region/culture, e.g. "Etiquette (Lowlands) 3".

FALCONRY [Tier 1] (CHARISMA) (KNIGHTS ADD CLASS LEVEL)
A skill in the art of Falconry is a highly prized hunting skill and a good adventuring trick to boot.

1st: Call Falcon to arm/hand
2nd: Sick Falcon on prey
3rd: Tend Falcon
4th: Call Falcon from hearing range
5th: Sick Falcon on enemy
6th: Train Falcon for tricks
7th: Train Falcons
8th: Breed Falcons
9th: Speak with Falcons
10th: Falcon Armor: master takes all damage, halved, directed at Falcon (at will)
11th: Falcon Teeth: falcon adds master's bonus to damage
12th: Falcon Eye: see through Falcon's eyes once per day for a number of segments equal to level.
20th: Falcon Meld: switch bodies with Falcon once per week; takes one round;

CROSSOVER: AT LVL 6 GAIN/ADD ANIMAL TRAINING AND ANIMAL NOISE; AT LVL 12 ADD 1 LVL TO AIRBORNE RIDING SKILLS

GAMBLING [Tier 3] (WISDOM)
Ability to increase chances of winning

GAMING (POOL) [Tier 3] (DEXTERITY)
This is one of a number of different Gaming skills. Pool is a rare game of the Westron clan bosses. Played on a 5x10 table, the object is to sink your pool balls in the six pockets before your opponent.
d8 for number of critical shots/player. Then compete rolling half Dex + lvl on d20 for each shot
CROSSOVER: ADD HALF LEVEL TO ANY GAMBLING ROLLS

GUILD SIGNS [Tier 1] (INTELLIGENCE) (ROGUES ADD CLASS LEVEL) (DEFAULTS TO VERY HARD)
Ability to pick up an unknown guild sign once seen; roll vs. easy to notice that a guild sign being shown

HAGGLING [Tier 3] (CHARISMA)
Chance of getting the better deal

HEALING [Tier 2] (WISDOM) (CLERICS AND DRUIDS ADD CLASS LEVEL)
Bone setting, wound dressing, and all that. At level one, character may dress a wound so as to avoid further HP loss. At level two, wounds are dressed so as to allow healing and HP recovery. Success margin is added in HP to the weekly healing.

HEAR NOISE [Tier 2] (INTELLIGENCE + CLASS LEVEL FOR ROGUES) (DEFAULTS TO VERY HARD)

Elves, halflings and Half-Orcs have a bonus of 1, and Orcs have a bonus of 2.

HERALDRY [Tier 2] (INTELLIGENCE) (DEFAULTS TO EASY)
Study of heraldic etiquette and historic symbols

At first level, one is familiar with the standard rules of heraldry, and may function as Herald. Heralds are familiar with all their continent's flags of state.
At third level, one is fully trained in the basic rules, and may be hired out as a Master of Heraldry, Master of Colors, or Court Heraldic Advisor. Third level Heralds are familiar with most regional flags,

making a Wisdom Check + Skill Level to make sure.
At fifth level, one may become a Master Heraldic; a position of respect in court.

CROSSOVER: AT LVL 5 GAIN/ADD ETIQUETTE FOR THAT CULTURE

HERBAL LORE [Tier 1] (WISDOM) (DRUIDS AND RANGERS ADD CLASS LEVEL)
There are two main functions: discovering magical herbs in the wilderness, and identifying magical herbs once found. Obviously just one roll if you know what you are looking for, but the first roll allows for a generic herb hunt.

HISTORY LORE [Tier 2] (WISDOM)
General history knowledge with a focus on 1 region/culture (noted "History Lore (Lowlands) 4").
CROSSOVER: AT LVL 5 GAIN/ADD HERALDRY 1.0 - AT LVL 10 GAIN/ADD ETIQUETTE 1.0

INQUISITION [Tier 3] (DEXTERITY OR INTELLIGENCE) (ASSASSINS ADD CLASS LEVEL)
Ability to force information from someone through pain and persuasion. Without the use of a torture chamber or similar tools, roll against Very Hard. Charisma modifiers: 5 or below or 16 above, add 1. For every point of Comeliness below 5 add 1.

JUGGLING [Tier 2] (DEXTERITY)

1st level: fire-spitting
2nd level: 4 items
3rd level: knives
4th level: torches
7th level: 5 items
8th level: sword swallowing
9th level: 1 extra attack with thrown knives

(lvl + dex + 1d6) x 2= # of segments
CROSSOVER: AT LVL 6 GAIN/ADD CARNIVAL GEEK

LITERACY [Tier 3] (INTELLIGENCE)
Written forms of language. Most Characters start with Literacy at the same level as their language score(s); noted as Thurne 6/6.

LOCKS [Tier 1] (DEXTERITY) (ROGUES ADD CLASS LEVEL) (DEFAULTS TO VERY HARD FOR ROGUES, EXTREMELY HARD FOR OTHERS)

Dwarves add 1, halflings and orcs add 1, elves subtract 1.

MUSIC [Tier 3] (DEXTERITY FOR MOST INSTRUMENTS) (DEFAULTS TO EASY)
Per instrument

lvl	title	admir	charm	1d6	2d4	gp/wk
1	novice	00%	00%	00%	00%	0gp
5	apprentice	10%	00%	00%	00%	1gp
7	professional	20%	00%	00%	00%	2gp
8	minor feller	55%	01%	00%	00%	5gp
9	player	80%	02%	00%	00%	9gp
10	expert player	90%	05%	00%	00%	12gp
11	grand player	99%	08%	00%	00%	25gp
12	minstrel	99%	10%	00%	00%	30gp
13	grand minstrel	99%	15%	00%	00%	35gp
14	high minstrel	99%	18%	00%	00%	40gp
15	master	99%	25%	02%	00%	50gp
16	balladeer	99%	30%	04%	00%	55gp
17	feller	99%	35%	07%	01%	70gp
18	grand balladeer	99%	40%	12%	02%	80gp
19	master balladeer	99%	50%	20%	05%	100gp
20	troubadour	100%	75%	30%	10%	300gp

lvl = rating out of 10
CROSSOVER: AT LVL 10 GAIN ANOTHER MUSIC SKILL - AT LVL 15 ANOTHER

NAVIGATION [Tier 2] (INTELLIGENCE) (DEFAULTS TO EASY)

1st, understand most nautical maps.
3rd, understand all nautical maps.
4th, navigate small ships by coast.
5th, navigate medium ships by coast.
6th, navigate all ships by coast.
8th, navigate by stars (if sextant and knowledge exist)

PICK POCKETS [Tier 1] (DEXTERITY + CLASS LEVEL FOR ROGUES) (DEFAULTS TO EXTREMELY HARD)
This skill applies to shoplifting, picking pockets and all that good stuff.

Elves and halflings add 2, half-elves add 1, and half-orcs subtract 1

RIDING, LAND [Tier 3] [Warhorse: Tier 1] (DEXTERITY + CLASS LEVEL FOR RANGERS)
There are two versions: Riding Horse and War Horse (War Horse is a Tier 1 skill). Both of them follow the same chart, with Riding Horse ignoring any abilities in italics.

If you have the Riding Horse skill you can ride a war horse but do not gain any of the fighting abilities (although a war horse could be made to trample someone, just not attack).

If you have the War Horse skill you can ride a riding horse but any special attacks that require the horse's cooperation will be more (or extremely) difficult.

[Note rules for charging and trampling under Chapter 2 - 1.5 MOUNTED COMBAT]

lvl 01: may ride mount / fight at -4 / bow fired while stopped at -1
lvl 02: *fight at -3* / bow fire while stopped without penalty

lvl 03: *fight at -2* / *THWeapon at -4*
lvl 04: *THWeapon -3* / bow while riding -4
lvl 05: *fight at -1* / *THWeapon -2* / leap on mount in 1 sg
lvl 06: *fight without penalty* / bow while riding -3
lvl 07: *THWeapon -1* / bow while riding -2 / leap from mount in 1 sg
lvl 08: *THWeapon no penalty* / bow while riding -1 / leap from mount in 1 sg and prepare for fight
lvl 09: urge mount 1 faster
lvl 10: bow while riding no penalty / *charge at +2 dmg*
lvl 11: spot best horse in herd
lvl 12: *charge at +3 dmg*
lvl 13: urge mount 2 faster
lvl 14: no damage falling from horse
lvl 15: *leap from mount and get 1 stroke in 1 sg*
lvl 16: *leap on mount w/ armor in 1 sg*

CROSSOVER: AT LVL 6 GAIN/ADD ANIMAL TRAINING - AT LVL 17 GAIN ANOTHER LAND RIDING

RIDING, AIR [Tier 1] (DEXTERITY)

lvl 01: can fly, can't use hands
lvl 04: can use one hand, fight at -2
lvl 06: fight at no penalty
lvl 07: lance at -2
lvl 09: lance no penalty
lvl 10: fight two-handed -4
lvl 12: lance +2 dmg
lvl 14: fight TH -2
lvl 15: bow at -4
lvl 16: lance +4 dmg
lvl 17: fight at no penalty
lvl 19: bow at -2
lvl 20: no penalty on bow

SAILING, RIVER [Tier 3] (WISDOM)

1st, considered a boatsman.
3rd, manage small cargo boats.
5th, manage all cargo boats.
6th, manage all river boats.
8th, skilled over rapids, sand bars, etc.
10th, exceptional boatsman.

CROSSOVER: SEA SAILING AT HALF LEVEL

SAILING, SEA [Tier 3] (WISDOM)

1st lvl, may be considered a sailor.
3rd, competent sailor.
4th, command rowing.
5th, could run a barge or smaller ship within bay or port.
6th, run a galley.

7th, navigate by coast.
8th, run a small sailing ship.
9th, run a medium sailing ship.
10th, navigate well.
11th, run a large sailing ship.
12th, navigate by stars

CROSSOVER: RIVER SAILING AT HALF LEVEL- AT LVL 5 GAIN/ADD NAVIGATION

SHADOWS [Tier 1] (DEXTERITY + CLASS LEVEL FOR ROGUES)
Ability to hide in any available shadows

Elves have a bonus of 2 and Half-Elves 1 (only if they are in a natural environment); Halflings get +2.

SMITH [Tier 2] (DEXTERITY, INTELLIGENCE OR WISDOM)
Metalworking skills

lvl 01; small repairs
lvl 02; simple tools
lvl 03; standard repairs
lvl 05; shields
lvl 07; complex tools, simple weapons
lvl 09; weapons
lvl 11; ringmail
lvl 12; scalemail
lvl 13; chainmail / simple locks
lvl 14; banded mail
lvl 15; splintmail
lvl 16; bronze plate / good locks
lvl 17; platemail
lvl 18; field plate / very good locks
lvl 20; ARTISAN full plate and any other item
lvl 25; MASTER ARTISAN lvl% chance of making exceptional tool

CROSSOVER: AT LVL 3 GAIN/ADD CRAFTSMANSHIP

"It took me awhile, but after a few months the spell wore off and I realized that Talon probably wasn't my best friend and he might not even have my best interests at heart. Thank the gods I'm higher level now - those were embarrassing days."
Kilmontora
(scrawled in the mens room at the Triumvirate Guild)

SPITTING [Tier 3] (CONSTITUTION OR DEXTERITY)
Ability to spit at far distances
4' at 1st, and 1' per level afterwards

"Your mother may birth you, but it's the street and its cobblestoned flesh that raises you."
Master Thief Morid, attributed

STEALTH [Tier 1] (DEXTERITY + CLASS LEVEL FOR ROGUES) (DEFAULTS TO EXTREMELY HARD)

Elves have a bonus of 2, Half-Elves 1, and Haffers 2.

STREETWISE [Tier 3] (INTELLIGENCE OR CHARISMA)
Ability to obtain information from "the streets", as well as navigate urban areas so as to trail someone (or likewise ditch someone). Information rolls are on Charisma, tailing/ditching rolls are Intelligence.

CROSSOVER: AT LVL 6 GAIN/ADD INTERROGATION

SWIMMING [Tier 3] (DEXTERITY OR CONSTITUTION)
Hold breath underwater for a number of rounds equal to a third of Constitution + 1 per level.

1st; tread water
2nd; swim meagerly
3rd; swim
4th; dive
5th; swim well

TRACKING [Tier 2] (WISDOM + RANGERS ADD CLASS LEVEL) (RESTRICTED: RANGERS AND DRUIDS ONLY)
Elves, Half-Elves, Orcs and Half-Orcs add 1. Devout followers of a nature deity add 1 (applies to characters worshipping a god of nature like the Elephant God, Tempes, Falasrion, druidic cults of Tala and Sylas, etc)

TRAPS [Tier 1] (INTELLIGENCE + 5% PER CLASS LEVEL) (RESTICTED: THIEVES AND ASSASSINS ONLY) (SPECIAL: ROLL ON PERCENTILE)
This is the quintessential adventuring skill, allowing the character to find and remove traps. A first roll to find the trap, a second to disarm it. This skill can be used for trapped locks, doors, hallways, floors, ceilings, etc. On surfaces, each roll covers a 10'X10' area.

Dwarves add 15%, haffers and half-orcs add 5%, and orcs add 10%. There is also a modifier for Dexterity (see Dex chart under Dexterity)

WILDLIFE [Tier 2] (CHARISMA OR WISDOM + CLASS LEVEL FOR DRUIDS AND RANGERS)
The ability to befriend animals, learn from them, and solicit their aid.

Druids add 2, Elves add 2, Half-Elves add 1, Devout followers of a nature deity add 1 (applies to characters worshipping a god of nature like the Elephant God, Tempes, Falasrion, druidic cults of Tala and Sylas, etc)

CROSSOVER: AT LVL 5 GAIN/ADD ANIMAL TRAINING - AT LVL 8 GAIN/ADD ANIMAL NOISE

3.0 LANGUAGES IN TELRHIN

Language ability is rated on a scale of 1-10, incorporating how long one has known the tongue, how well versed one is and one's intelligence. An intelligent, schooled person speaking their native tongue will most likely have a score of 8 in that tongue. 10 is total mastery with a command of virtually every facet of grammar, vocabulary and poetic/literary elements. 3 is bare the minimum to converse (common words and basic grammar).

1 Only a few words
2 Very limited
3 May converse poorly
4 May converse
5 Fluency
6 Sound knowledge of the language (full fluency)
7 Skilled use of the tongue
8 Highly skilled and versatile
9 Mastery of all forms and vast vocabulary
10 Complete knowledge of every facet of the tongue

Language is the spoken ability -- the *Runetongue* skill covers reading and writing.

The Field Guide covers language in more detail. This is the short list of common languages spoken in the main parts of the world:

Thurne (many dialects) (mostly among Westrons), Common Thine (in the Empire), Akos (in Akania), Tagani (in Khitagan), Shile (in Shadis), Black Speech (mostly among Orcs, Goblins, Kobolds), Sindarin (the more commonly spoken Elven tongue) and Khuzdul (Dwarves).

Most games are set in the Lowlands region where Thurne is the common tongue and almost everyone is able to at least understand it; in the port city of Lark-Han, the major city of the Lowlands, half the languages of the world are spoken, including the local mish-mash dialect of Tagani called “cho-cho” along with the Vijmani and Araketi dialects of Thurne.

Everyone’s favorite language of Orcish goes something like this:

Orcish/Black Speech Glossary:
For a plural, add the suffix `a'. For a past action add `dotad' or `gakdar' to denote future. Naturally, Black Speech has regionalisms and dialects. This particular one is modified from an article in *Dragon Magazine*, issue #75 (reprinted in *Adventure Log* issues 22 and 41).

AND(conj) - ak
ANIMAL(n) - ragdar
ARMOR(n) - gandan
ARMY/WARBAND(n) - joktar
AT(prep) - ag
ATTACK(v) - dak
ATTACK(n) - dakzog
AXE(n) - ekdog
BED(n) - derdar
BIG/GREAT(adj) - hai
BITCH(n) - mekgon
BLANKET(n) - derdak
BONE(n) - mardred
BREAK(v) - dod
BRICK(n) - kettak
BRIGHT(adj) - gatad
BROTHER(n) - balg
BURN(v) - det
BUT(conj) - ek
CARRY(v) - dog
CAVE(n) – null
CHARGE(v) - kot
CHEST(n) - zekar
CITY/TOWN(n) - ejtag
CLIMB(v) - teg
CLOAK(n) - darad
CLOSE/SHUT(v) - gen
CLUB(n/v) - thola
COLD(adj) - etar
COME(v) - zen
COMING(n) - zenak
COMPANY(n) - roktor
COW/BOVINE(n) - vash
CUT(v) - gek
DAGGER/KNIFE(n) - jortak
DANGER(n) - nartag
DARK(adj) - gerdak
DARKNESS(n) - ikdak
DAY(n) - zandag
DEATH(n) - ikot

DEER(n) - rorad
DEFEND(v) - gag
DIE(v) - ot
DIG(v) - gar
DOG(n) - gojak
DOWN(adj/adv) - zegor
DRINK(n) - aztar
DRINK(v) - az
DWARF(n) - kez
EAST(n) - gokzek
EAT(v) - gad
ELF(n) - rekar
ENEMY(n) - rargad
FAR(adj/adv) - gotrak
FAST(adj/adv) - tortan
FIGHT(v) - dek
FIRE(n) - detad
FLANK(n) - togtad
FOOD(n) - gadduj
FOR(prep) - oj
FORMATION(n) - kejar
FRONT(n) - rekton
FUCK(v) - tigdar
FUTURE(adv) - gakdar
GATE(n) - netdag
GET/FETCH(v) - doj
GIVE(v) - doja
GO(v) - zor
GOING(n) - zorak
GREAT ORC(n) - uruk-hai
GUARD(v) - dej
GUARD(n) - dejad
HAMMER(n) - gettok
HARD(adj/adv) - gegor
HE/HIM(n) - darag
HELMET(n) - ozrad
HORSE(n) - gozak
HOT(adj) - dendad
HOW(adv/conj) - or
HUNT(v) - jar
HUNT(n) - jarag
HUMAN(n) - rannor
HUNTER(n) - jardak
I/ME(n) - dagad
IF(conj) - eg
IN(prep) - aj
IRON(n) - nak
IS/AM/TO BE(v) - tot
KILL(v) - dez
LEAD(v) - jed
LEADER/OFFICER(n) - jeddar
LEFT(n) - rakan
LIKE/AS(prep) - ad
LISTEN/HEAR(v) - dan
LOOSE(adj) - konad
LUNA(n) - mek-deztej
MAGIC(n) - arash
MAKE/BUILD(v) - tek
MANY(adj) - zejdad
MARCH(v) - dok
MOVE(v) - tor
NEST(n) - narl
NEAR(adj) - gotrag
NIGHT(n) - zakdag
NO/NEGATIVE(adv) - zozgat
NORTH(n) - todreg
OBEY(v) - jeg
OF/FROM(prep) - og
OPEN(v) - nez
OR(conj) - ok
ORC(n) - uruk
ORDER(v) - jen
ORDER(n) - jendad
OVERLORD(n) - jeddar-hai
OWN(v) - zek
PARRY(v) - gaj
PAST(adv) - dotad
REAR(n) - rontak
RETREAT(v) - noj
RIDE(v) - rej
RIGHT(n) - tokan
RUN(v) - raz
SADDLE(n) - orgad
SAFE/SAFETY(adj/n) - noztan
SCOUT(v) - gon
SCOUT(n) - gontad
SEX(n) - tig
SERGEANT(n) - jegdan
SHAMAN(n) - mule
SHEEP(n) - nef
SHIELD(n) - gandal
SHOOT(v) - jez
SHUT/CLOSE(v) - rot
SKULL(n) - Ozmad
SLEEP(v) - der
SLOW(adv) - tontag
SMALL/LITTLE(adj) - mek
SOFT(adj) - gezan
SOUTH(n) - takren
SQUAD(n) - jok
STAND(v) - nak
STEAL(v) - dez
STONE(n) - kordad
STOP/HALT(v) - gej
SURRENDER(v) - jegokot
SWORD(n) - dotak
TAKE(v) - don
TALA(n) - mekgon-hai
THIEF(n) - deztej
THREATEN(v) - nar
THRUST(v) - zok
TIGHT(adj) - kozad
TO(prep) - od
TOMB(n) - otnull
TREASURE/WEALTH(n) - doztat
TREE(n) - tadnen
TWO/TWICE(adj/adv) - ithic
UP(adv/prep) - tegat
WAIT(v) - nach
WALL(n) - kokad
WATCH(v) - kel
WATER(n) - dozar
WEST(n) - gogker
WHAT(n/adv) - ar
WHEN(adv/conj) - an
WHERE(adv/conj) - er
WHO/WHOM(n) - on
WHY(adv/conj) - en
WINE(n) - tagrat
WITH(prep) - ed
WOLF(n) - ukor
WOMAN/FEMALE(n) - tigjar
WOOD(n) - dortod
WORG(n) - ukor-hai
YES/AFFIRMATIVE - tojat
YOU(n) - dakar

4.0 GOD ROLLS and the MORTAL COIL

If you're out of Hero Points this is the last resort. All characters have a God Roll equivalent to 10% + 1% per level (Clerics, Paladins and Druids roll 10% + 2% per lvl). If the character has a Hero Point they can add another 2% to the total. Though best saved for life threatening crises, a character can attempt a God Roll at any time. Even faithless infidels can spontaneously discover religion. Failing the roll reduces your God Roll total by 2%, which is not usually a problem if you're dead. A successful God Roll indicates that your character's deity or delegated servant has heard your prayer. It doesn't guarantee that they will intervene, and this is where the piety and devotion come in.

And after this? Once you slither out of your mortal coil? Once the connection between your spirit and body is broken your life ends. Your spirit is at the mercy of circumstance, and though many spirits make a successful journey to the celestial realms, it's a perilous trip. Spirits can get caught in the Carnival of Souls or forced into bondage by the Myrgboni and auctioned off to the pleasures of the lich kings of Astaniell. Although this could make for a great storyline, it's at this point that (for your character at least) the campaign ends.

"...And to all those whose quest is just a little more than mortal; to you whose soul is not so earthly chained, whose dreams are brighter and roads are higher-bound - to you I bow and offer my admiration as well as company, though the latter be only in spirit."

Lord Zodmius, Baron of Lark-Han

Appendix A
Character Generation Charts

Social Status and Wealth

The breakdown doesn't reflect the demographics of average people, just the demographics of adventurers. If you already have one of the free skills then it adds a level to the existing skill.

Base Starting Money:

Cleric/Druid	30-180 (3d6)
Fighter/Ranger	50-200gp (5d4)
Mage	20-80 (2d4)
Rogues (all)	20-120 (2d6)
Paladin/Knight	60-240 (6d4)

Paladins/Knights add +15%, Mages +10%, Rogues -10%

01-05	Dirt Poor (Serf / Slave)
06-20	Poor
21-80	Working Class
81-94	Artisan, Merchant Class
95-99	Wealthy
00	Untitled Nobility

Dirt Poor
You are a freed serf or slave!
Starting money is in silver. You also have an extra roll on the 'bogey tables'.

Poor
You are a filthy poor person!
Starting money is halved.

Working Class
You are a working stiff!
Normal starting money.

Artisan/Merchant Class
You are a spoiled bourgeois bastard!
Starting money + 2 more dice. You also start with a weapon of your choice, fine clothes and basic gear*.

Wealthy
You are part of the evil wealthy elite!
Double starting money. You also start with 2 weapons of your choice, a mount (riding horse), fine clothes and gear*. You start with a free skill in the arts (Music, Acting, etc)

Untitled Nobility
You are an inbred blue-blood!
Double starting money (nobles aren't always rich). You also begin with the armor of your choice, 2 weapons of your choice, a mount (any kind, including heavy war horse), fine clothes and gear*. You start with Heraldry and Riding (horse) as well as a free skill in the arts (Music, Acting, etc). You have a 0 level family servant to kick around. You also have an extra roll on a random Bogey Table you inbred freak!

*Gear is your basic coin pouch, backpack, water skin, knife/fork, and tinder box.

Quirks, Flaws and Traits

Traits
(traits purchased with Building Points)

important ally, loyal servant, Sight, magic resistance (ST bonus), light sleeper, low-light vision, poison immunity, iron hide (-1 AC), congeniality (+1 Cha rolls, bartering), huge bladder

Quirks and Flaws
New characters make a Charisma, Wisdom and Constitution check, with modifiers based on social class and maybe race. A failed roll means a roll in that category (nat 20 means 2 rolls, a 1 means a free re-roll in a different category roll). Can buy off with either 1 attribute point (choice), 250 Building Points or dropping 1 social rank. Also, a character can opt to make a voluntary roll on a random category for 500 Building Points – no rerolls, no buy-offs, you get what you get, only 1 time.

This table borrows liberally from the 1981 uber-gamer classic *Fantasy Wargaming* that Corbin discovered back in middle school.

Bogey Table 1: Social (Charisma)
1. Rayikian
2. Bastard
3. Family shame
4. Homosexual/Asexual
5. Atheist
6. Misunderstood foreign god
7. Mismatched eyes (social witch stigma)
8. Faie aura, undead aura
9. Dark god aura
10. Ginger

Bogey Table 2: Psychological (Wisdom)
1. Kleptomaniac
2. Sexual fetish
3. Compulsive clean freak
4. Homophobia
5. Agoraphobia
6. Painful shyness/introversion
7. Insomnia (slower healing, endurance penalty)
8. Hypochondria
9. Alcoholism
10. Gambling addiction

11. Paranoia
12. Misanthropy
13. Claustrophobia
14. Agoraphobia
15. Fear of water
16. Fear of heights
17. Fear of spiders
18. Fear of snakes

Bogey Table 3: Physical (Constitution)

1. Tiny bladder
2. Lazy eye
3. Cross-eyed
4. Body hair
5. Hair Lip
6. Body odor
7. Acne
8. Warts
9. Easy bruiser
10. Stutter
11. Nervous tic
12. Poor sight (near sighted -1 range attacks, farsighted -1 melee)
13. Deafness (hard of hearing)
14. Stammer
15. Limp
16. Asthma
17. Comprised immune system
18. Snoring

Appendix B

Jump Start Sample Tables

These tables are a sample from our 2008 DC dungeon crawl at Corbin & Elizabeth's

Jump-Start Tables for 3rd Level Characters

Past Adventuring Success (d8, roll once)

1 = Things Weren't So Good – "Lots of Orcs, But I Still Have My Fingers": You've managed to keep your armor out of the pawn shop but that's about it. You start with dinged up armor of your choice, a sickly but technically "alive" mount of your choice, one each of your proficient weapons (plus arrows or bolts of course), 100 silver pieces, patched and worn clothes, and camping gear. You get one less roll on the Potions table and one additional roll on the Injuries and Issues table. You have 1 less Hero Point.

2-5 = Things Were OK – "Lots of Orcs Not So Much Gold": You start with armor of your choice, mount of your choice, one each of your proficient weapons (plus arrows or bolts of course), 100 gold pieces, clothes, and camping gear.

6-7 = Things Were Great – "Drunk Orcs and Plenty of Loot": You start with excellent armor of your choice, a fine mount of your choice, one each of your proficient weapons (plus arrows or bolts of course), 500 gold pieces, lots of fine clothes, and camping gear. You also have several gems worth a combined 100 gold. You have an extra roll on the Potions chart.

8 = Things Were Fantastic – "Dragon Was Already Dead and the Princess Was Hot": You start with everything you can fit on your amazing horse/mount. You have the best armor, clothes, equipment and other adventuring gear money can buy. You also have 500 gold and another 1000 gold in assorted gems. You also have a knighthood and some fan mail. You have an extra roll on the Potions AND Weapons charts. You have 1 extra Hero Point.

Skills

Add 1 level to 3 separate skills and then add 4 total levels any way you want (all on one or spread out over several).

Injuries and Issues (d10, roll twice)

(Any result on this table can be ignored by taking one less roll on the Potions table – ALSO: by opting for a 3rd roll on this table you GAIN a roll on the Potions table but you have to stick with the results)

Same result = "double up!"

1. Major scar somewhere on the body from past battle
2. Scar on face: -1 Comeliness from past battle
3. Missing Finger (your choice): -1 Dex from past battle
4. Agoraphobia – acquired through traumatic adventure: Wisdom check or suffer -1 to all rolls when out in wide open spaces
5. Rayikian follower (you are a follower of the Rayikian religion, a bunch of trouble making foreigners who worship silly gods): -2 to Charisma when around non-Rayikians
6. Acid burns on feet from a "poor choice" in a past dungeon crawl

7. Strange body odor from “adventure” with druids early in career
8. -1 on Drinking Rolls from liver damage
9. Fear of Kobolds (from past adventure): -2 to hit but +2 damage vs. Kobolds
10. Purple spots on body from past potion immiscibility (-2 comeliness)

Weapons & Armor (d6, roll once)

Note: ‘c’ as in +1c means it’s a non-magical bonus (‘c’ for “craft”)

1. +2 Dagger (regular)
2. +1 Armor (of your choosing)
3. +1C arrows (2) or bolts (2)
4. +1 Throwing Dagger
5. +1 Codpiece
6. “lucky bandana” from early adventuring years (non-magical but man does it reek)

Potions and Herbs (d20, roll 3 times or 4 if you got the “lucky bandana”)

1. Potion: Healing d8
2. Potion: Xtra Healing 2d8
3. Potion: Unknown “mystery” potion!
4. Potion: Strength +1 for 1 hour
5. Potion: All Saving Throws +1 for 1 hour
6. Potion: Speed (+1 MOVE) for 1 hour
7. Potion: Safety (+2 AC for 1 hour)
8. Potion: Cure for Common Cold
9. Potion: Well Marked Vial of Poison! Nasty smelling hard to disguise black ichor. ST v Poison or die painfully in d20 minutes.
10. Extra Roll!
11. Herb: 1d3 Windclamit (fruit – boil and eat) 3d10 HP insta-heal!
12. Herb: 2d10 Thurl Cloves (crush and mix with water for 1 HP insta-heal)
13. Herb: 1 Burdock Root (boil and eat) syphilis, boils and gout
14. Herb: 3d6 Ankii Berry (eat – restores as good night’s sleep) (if used 2x in given week: -1 Constitution for a week, 3 times: -3 Con, -2 Comeliness, and some projectile vomiting for a week, and oddly enough if taken more than that it just has no effect other than strange colored pee)
15. Extra Roll!
16. Herb: Asparagus
17. Herb: 2d4 Ardis Flower (eat the petals to restore temporary blindness)
18. Herb: 1 Mystery Berry (unknown effect – orange berry the size of a pea – are you feeling lucky?)
19. Herb: Breldiar (flower – use as spell component to double spell duration and halve casting time, but for duration of spell fighting level is at half and defensive adjustment from dexterity is cancelled due to severe gas)
20. Herb: d4 Elben’s Basket (root – eat it for instant effect – “hasted” for one combat round but make a Constitution check or be incapacitated instead with heart pains)

Rings (d6, roll once – each item is unique and removed from the list)

1. Ring of Feather Fall, d3 charges
2. Gold Ring worth 100gp
3. Overmeyer Ring – this increases the number of magical rings that can be worn AND can be used to hide a magical ring by covering it (both appear as 1 non-magical ring until removed)
4. Ring of Protection +1
5. Ring of Poison Saving Throw +d10 (roll before each use!)
6. Ring of Fire Resistance

Magical Heirlooms (d6 roll once – each item is unique and removed from the list)

1. Pappy Felton's Pewter Pint: Drinking from this raises your Alcohol Chugging skill by 4 levels. It also improves the taste and adds +2 to any saving throw from anything poisonous. Dented from being used as a highly effective "improvised bar brawl device" (+2 damage)
2. Grannie's Soup Ladle: The gaudy swan-shaped silver ladle might have been pawned off generations ago if it weren't for the fact that it detects poisons (by ringing like a tuning fork) and does d4+2 damage when used as a weapon.
3. Shoelaces of Irritation: if worn on the left foot they increase Dex by 1 (max 18), if worn on the right they increase Str by 1 (max 17), but regardless the wearer has to make a Charisma check once a day or burst out with a tourette's style assault on whoever is closest (equate to halving their Charisma for that encounter)
4. Hair Ribbon of Bar Brawling: This dashing hair ribbon increase Brawling skills by 2 levels.
5. Dumb Stone (once a day if you toss the stone in the air it will strike the dumbest person within 20 feet for d3 HP)
6. Clothing Item of Exquisite Taste and Fashion Sense: this clothing item (your choice) is so exquisitely cool that even a toothless crone can't walk past without gawking. +2 comeliness while worn.